NINE LIVES GANG

A tabletop roleplaying game of street cats, sticky paws and getting away with it

Get in. Grab the loot. Don't get pinched.



VERSION 0.9 · DRAFT

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TYPEFACES

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PLAY IT ONLINE

Nine Lives Gang for Foundry Virtual Tabletop, coming soon

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PART ONE

The Gang

Who you are, how it works, and the crew you'll run with.





CHAPTER 1

This Street Is Ours

"A whole chicken. In a bag. She took it inside and shut the door on us." "Did she, now. Nobody shuts a door on this gang." — Pip and Big Biscuit

YOU ARE A GANG OF STREET CATS: ALLEY TOUGHS WITH notched ears, bandanas, big talk and nine lives' worth of swagger. You run the bins, the car roofs and the warm tiles over the bakery, and everything shiny on this street is yours, sooner or later. Tonight one of you saw a human carry something into a house: something **delicious**, something **fun**, something **shiny**, or **a box**. No plan, no casing the joint: the whole gang wants it, now. Break in, grab the loot, leg it over the fences — and don't get pinched by the Five-O (that's animal control).

Nine Lives Gang is a tabletop roleplaying game for **3 to 5 players** and one **Storyteller**, for ages 8 and up. Each player is one cat in the gang. The Storyteller plays the house: the humans who live there, their pets, and the prize that is about to be eaten, played with or put away. One robbery takes about one to two hours.

What you need

- **Six-sided dice** — about ten for the table. A roll never uses more than five.
- An **eight-sided die** (d8) for making cats. No d8? Roll a d6 twice and use the table's note.
- A **cat sheet** for each player, the **house tracker** for the Storyteller and the **quick reference** for everyone (all at the back of this book), and pencils.
- A handful of **tokens** (coins, buttons, cat treats) for Cattitude, and a counter for each cat, human and pet to put on the map.
- The house you'll hit — its pages, with the map. Part Four has five ready to go.

How a job goes

1. **Make your cats** (Chapter 2), or pick from the ready-made gang (Chapter 3).
2. **The human goes in.** The Storyteller reads the start of the house: who lives there, and what the human just carried inside.
3. **Pick your ways in.** Every house has several entrances — a cat flap, a window left open, the gap behind the human's legs. The crew can split up.
4. **Play in rounds.** Each round starts with the **Prize Clock**: is the prize being put down, moved or taken away? Then every cat gets one Move and one Action. Then the house moves: the humans wander and the dog sniffs about.
5. **Get it, and get out.** Eat it where it is, or get it outside — and get every cat outside too.
6. **The getaway.** Leg it over the fences with the loot before the Five-O pinches you (Chapter 9).
7. **Count the loot that got home:** a **Clean Getaway**, a **Messy Getaway**, or **Busted**.

THE WHOLE GAME ON ONE HAND

To do something tricky, roll some six-sided dice and look at the highest one. A 6 means it works. A 4 or 5 means it works, but you made a noise. A 1, 2 or 3 means it didn't work, and you made a noise. Two 6s is **Purrfect**.

Being seen isn't being caught. Being seen doing something is. Every time a human sees you do something, their mood fills up — towards the **Broom** if you're naughty, towards a **Cuddle** if you're sweet. Fill one all the way and a cat gets chased out or scooped up.

Cartoon rules

This gang is tough, but this is a cartoon. Cats always land on their feet, dogs only ever bark and chase, the broom only ever sweeps a cat out of the door, and the warden's net mostly catches bin lids. Nobody gets hurt. But the stakes are real: a pinched cat goes to the pound to sulk, and a cat adopted from there swaps the street for a cushion and a bell on its collar. The gang will miss it. Loudly.

FOR THE STORYTELLER

Part Two is the rules, Part Three is how to run them, and Part Four is five houses ready to play. Read Chapter 12 before your first robbery; it has a checklist for every round.

Words to know

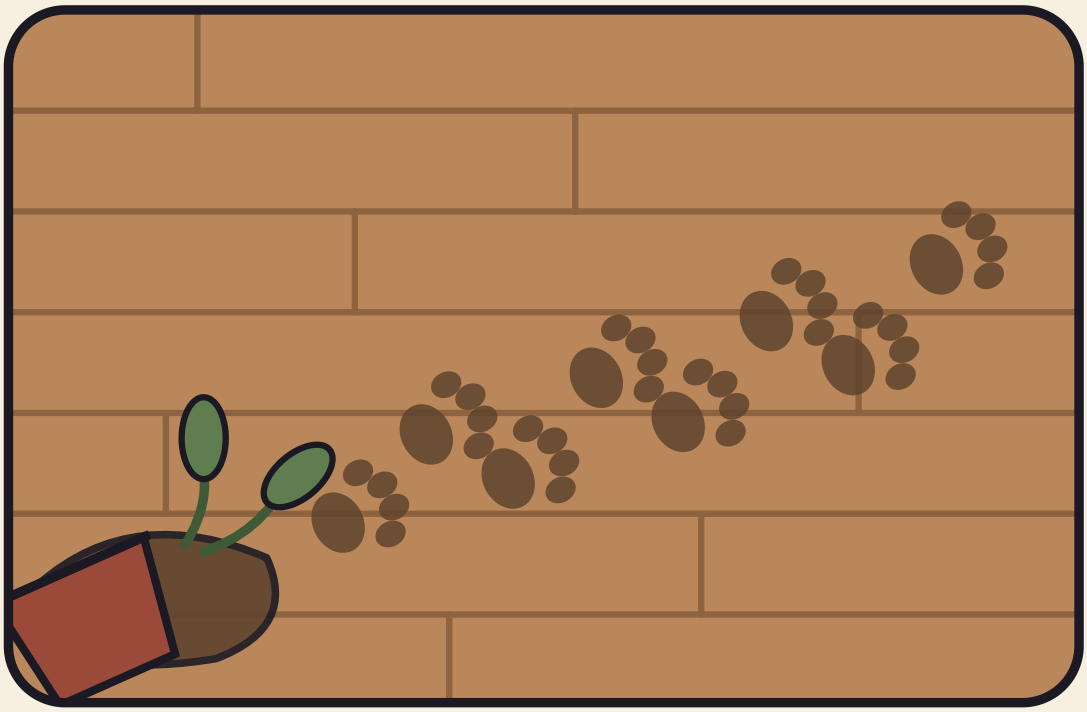
WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
Approach	How your cat does something: **Sneaky**, **Sweet**, **Savage** or **Streetwise**. Each has a rating of 1 to 4.
Instinct	Something your cat can't help doing, like knocking things off tables. It helps you (its **Knack**: +1 die when it suits what you do) — and tempts you.
Flop, Scrape, Clean, Purrfect	How a roll went: it didn't work; it worked noisily; it worked quietly; it worked perfectly (two 6s).
Push	Reroll every die that isn't a 6, once, for a price.
Cattitude	Your cat's swagger, kept as tokens. Spend it to Push or to resist a temptation.
Attention	How hard a human is to fool (0–2). It takes dice off Sneaky and Sweet rolls they watch.
Distracted	A human a cat has charmed: they see nobody until the house's turn.
The Mood	How the household feels about the cats: two meters, **Broom** and **Cuddle**.
Patience	How full a Mood meter can get before something happens: a full Broom means **Shoo!** (chased out); a full Cuddle means **Scooped!** (picked up and **Held**).
Den	The room a human shuts a held cat in. A friend can let it out.
Searching	A human who knows something's up: they hunt for the prize and the cats instead of following their routine.
Prize Clock	When the prize is put down and moved, and the round it's gone (eaten, put away or thrown out). **Lights Out** comes two rounds later: any cat still inside is pinched.
Pinched	Caught by animal control and taken to the pound. In a campaign a cat spends a Life to bust out.
Loot	What the gang got out of the house, in pieces, to carry home in the getaway.
Round	Every cat takes a turn, then the house does.
Storyteller	The player who runs the house and everyone in it.

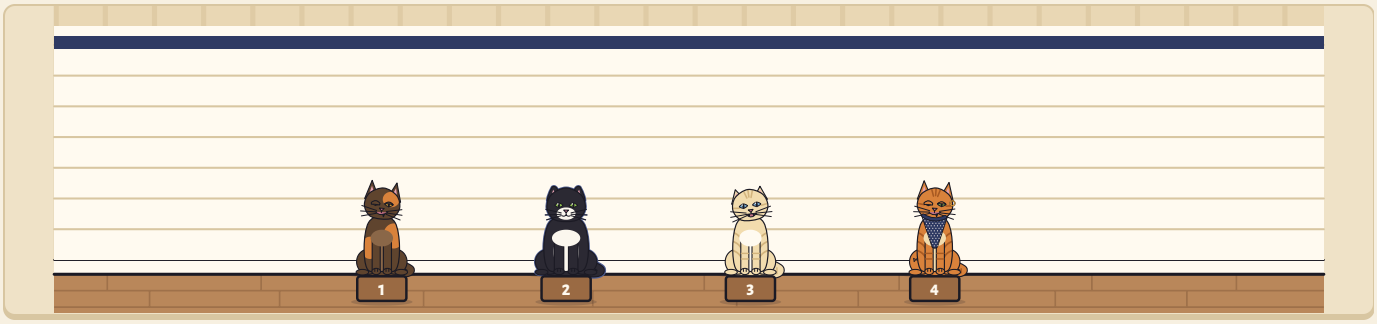
EXAMPLE OF PLAY

Storyteller: "Round 3. The chicken has sat on the kitchen counter since last round, still in its foil. Mr Pell is filling the kettle at the sink, humming, and Pudding thumps his tail in his basket. The kitchen window is wide open above the bins. Practically an invitation."

Tilly's player: "Tilly goes up the bins like she owns them and slips through the window behind his back. Sneaky!" Tilly has Sneaky 2, and climbing is her Knack (she's a Climber), but the window is Tricky and Mr Pell is right there (Attention 1): 2 + 1 − 1 − 1 = 1 die. She rolls a 6. A Sneaky Clean: she's in, and he never noticed a thing. Pudding did — and Tilly has used her Action climbing in, so she'll have to deal with him first thing next turn.

Big Biscuit's player: "Biscuit barges through the cat flap into the utility room — CLACK — and hides behind the washing machine. Smooth." No roll, but the flap makes a noise. In the house's turn Pudding barks at Tilly, but Mr Pell answers the first noise: he goes into the utility room to see what clacked, and finds nothing — leaving Tilly alone with the chicken and a very waggy dog…





CHAPTER 2

Making Your Cat

Every cat in the gang is a stray with a street name, a coat, a bit of bling and a way of doing things. Making one takes about five minutes. Pick from each table, or roll for it — or roll and keep what makes you laugh.

> **SEVEN STEPS**
>
> 1 a street name · 2 a coat, a mark and eyes · 3 approaches **3, 2, 1, 1** · 4 two instincts · 5 a body: Lean or Chonky · 6 a quirk · 7 Cattitude **2** and **9 Lives**.

1. A street name

Roll a d6 on each column, or pick. If another cat in the gang already has that name, roll the Name column again, or pick a name nobody has. Two-Bin Tilly got her name from the two bins she sleeps between.

D6	FIRST BIT	NAME
1	Alley	Tilly
2	Two-Bin	Joe
3	Gutter	Pearl
4	Lucky	Mags
5	Midnight	Dot
6	Lamppost	Sully

2. A coat, a mark, and eyes

These are for the story and for drawing your cat; they don't change the rules.

ROLL	COAT (D8)	MARK (D8)	EYES (D6)
1	Black	A notch in one ear	Green
2	Grey tabby	One white sock	Green
3	Ginger tabby	A kink at the tip of the tail	Amber
4	Brown tabby	A white star on the chest	Amber
5	Black and white	An old collar, too big	Blue
6	Calico	One crooked whisker	One of each
7	Tortoiseshell	A bandana (any colour)	—
8	Cream	A tattoo (a heart that says MUM, an anchor, the gang's sign)	—

No d8? (Coats, marks and instincts.) Roll a d6 until it shows 1–4, then roll it once more: on a 4–6 add 4 to the first number. That gives 1 to 8, all equally likely.

3. Your approaches

Every cat does things in four ways. Give your cat the ratings **3, 2, 1 and 1**, one to each approach, in any order. A rating is how many dice you roll when you do something that way.

APPROACH	WHEN YOU USE IT	THE GANG CALLS YOU…
Sneaky	Doing things without being noticed: hiding, slipping past, creeping, snatching something from under a nose.	the Shadow
Sweet	Charming humans and soft pets: rubbing round legs, purring, the slow blink, begging, being let in and out.	the Charmer
Savage	Force and speed: hissing, swatting, shoving, bolting, facing down a dog, wriggling free.	the Muscle
Streetwise	Knowing how things work: door handles, latches, cupboards, bags, the shortcut over the shed.	the Brains

Your 3 is your role. A good crew has a bit of everything.

To roll instead, roll a d6 for the approach that gets the 3: 1 Sneaky, 2 Sweet, 3 Savage, 4 Streetwise, 5–6 roll again. If another cat already has its 3 there, move along the list to the next approach nobody has at 3 (after Streetwise, go round to Sneaky); a fifth cat keeps what it rolled. Then roll a d6 for the 2 and count along the list from your 3, going round after Streetwise: 1–2 the next approach, 3–4 the one after, 5–6 the one after that. The other two get 1.

4. Two instincts

Roll a d8 twice, rerolling if you get the same one twice, or pick two. Each instinct gives you a **Knack** — an extra die when what you're doing suits it — and a **temptation**, something you find very hard to walk past. Chapter 7 says exactly what each one does.

D8	INSTINCT	KNACK: +1 DIE TO…	CAN'T RESIST…
1	Curious	open, search and figure things out	an open bag, a drawer, something new or shiny
2	Knocker	knock, push and topple things	a thing near the edge of a table, especially a sparkly one
3	Box Sitter	hide	a box, a bag, a basket
4	Hunter	pounce and chase (not fighting animals)	anything that moves
5	Lap Cat	charm a human	a warm lap, a sunny spot, a hand offering a stroke
6	Foodie	find, steal and eat food	food that isn't the prize
7	Climber	climb, jump and balance	somewhere high up
8	Scrapper	face down and fight animals	an awake dog or cat

5. A body

Roll a d6 or pick: **1–3 Lean**, **4–6 Chonky**.

- **Lean** cats fit through **Tight** gaps: a cracked window, a gap under a gate. They can carry Small things.
- **Chonky** cats can't fit through Tight gaps, but they can carry a **Medium** thing on their own, and they get **+1 die to wriggle free** when a human picks them up. There's a lot of them to hold.

6. A quirk

Roll a d6 or make one up: **1** hates the rain more than anything in the world; **2** collects bottle caps under the bakery steps; **3** was somebody's pet, once, and doesn't talk about it; **4** never forgets a face, especially a face with a broom; **5** sleeps on the warm roof of the launderette; **6** talks to pigeons (the pigeons don't talk back). Quirks are for fun; they never change the rules.

7. Cattitude and Lives

Every cat starts each robbery with **2 Cattitude** (take two tokens; 3 in a gang of three). You can hold up to **5**. You earn it by giving in to your instincts and by rolling Purrfects, and you spend it to Push a roll or to resist a temptation (Chapter 4). Spend it: it doesn't carry over.

Every cat has **9 Lives**. They only matter in a campaign (Chapter 14): when a cat gets pinched, a Life busts it out of the pound and back to the gang.

EXAMPLE: MAKING MARMALADE MAGS

Lena rolls 4 and 4, **Lucky Mags**, and makes it "Marmalade Mags": it sounds tougher. Ginger tabby, a kinked tail, green eyes. Sneaky 3, Savage 2. She rolls 3 and 4 on the d8: **Box Sitter** and **Hunter**. Body: **Lean**. Quirk: hates the rain. 2 Cattitude, 9 Lives.



CHAPTER 3

Meet the Gang

No time to make cats? Meet the Nine Lives Gang: five alley cats who think they own this street. Pick one each and get to work. With three players, leave out Pip and one of Tilly, Biscuit and Mags — keep Velvet, because every gang needs a charmer; with four, leave out Pip.

Two-Bin Tilly



"Every lid on this street has a trick. I invented most of them."

A grey tabby with green eyes, a brass stud in her ear, a fishbone tattoo on her right foreleg, and a red collar with a brass tag that says nothing at all. She's the Brains: she knows how doors open, which bins are full on Tuesdays, and the way over every fence.

Streetwise 3 · **Sneaky** 2 · **Sweet** 1 · **Savage** 1

Instincts Curious, Climber · **Body** Lean · **Quirk** never forgets a face

Big Biscuit



"I'm not saying move. I'm just saying I'm coming through."

A big brown tabby with a cream muzzle, amber eyes, a notch in his left ear, a black bandana on his head, a chunky gold chain, and the gang's sign — a cat's head with a 9 — tattooed on his right shoulder. He's the Muscle. Dogs think twice about him. So does the gang, when there's only one sardine left.

Savage 3 · **Streetwise** 2 · **Sweet** 1 · **Sneaky** 1

Instincts Scrapper, Foodie · **Body** Chonky · **Quirk** sleeps on the launderette roof

Velvet



"I don't break in. I get invited."

A sleek black cat with amber eyes, a white star on her chest and a white sock on her left forepaw. No bandana, no tattoo: the Charmer has to pass for a pet. One slow blink and a grown-up forgets what they came in for. She was a pet once. She doesn't talk about it.

Sweet 3 · **Sneaky** 2 · **Savage** 1 · **Streetwise** 1

Instincts Lap Cat, Knocker · **Body** Lean · **Quirk** was somebody's pet

Marmalade Mags



"You didn't see me. Nobody ever does."

A ginger tabby with green eyes, a small gold hoop in her left ear, a navy bandana with white dots round her neck and a kink at the tip of her tail. She's the Shadow: you won't see her come in or leave, and the chicken will be gone. If there's a box in the house, she's in it.

Sneaky 3 · **Savage** 2 · **Streetwise** 1 · **Sweet** 1

Instincts Box Sitter, Hunter · **Body** Lean · **Quirk** hates the rain

Pip



"I'm the toughest. Is that a STRING?"

The gang's kitten: a fluffy white calico with a ginger patch over her left eye, a black right ear, black spots and tail tip, and big blue eyes. Her pale blue bandana is far too big, and her medal is a shiny bottle cap. Humans melt. Then she knocks their tea over. She fits through any Tight gap.

Sweet 3 · **Savage** 2 · **Sneaky** 1 · **Streetwise** 1

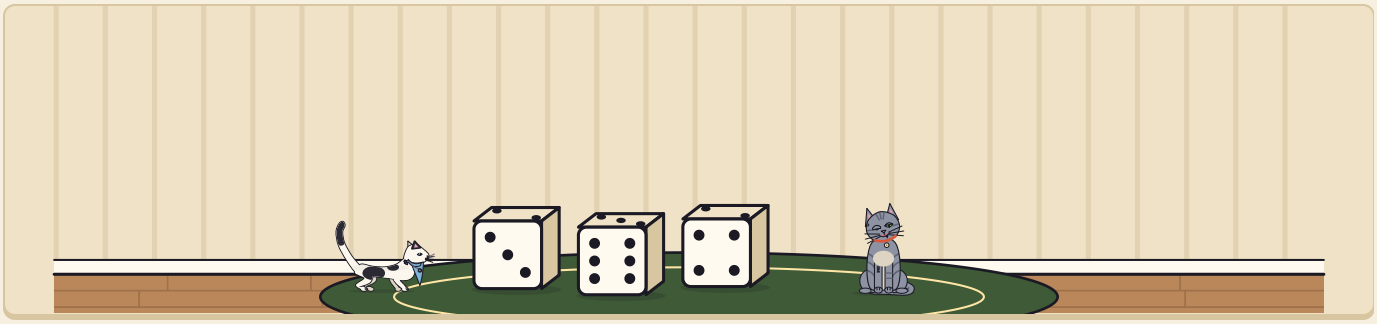
Instincts Hunter, Curious · **Body** Lean · **Quirk** talks to pigeons

PART TWO

The Job

How to roll, how the house feels about you, what happens when it's had enough — and how to leg it when the Five-O turns up.





CHAPTER 4

Rolling the Dice

Most of the time a cat just does things: swaggers into the hall, sniffs the doormat, sits on the stairs like it owns them. You only roll when something could go wrong — a climb, a latch, a dog, or anything a human might see.

When to roll

- When the house says a thing needs a roll: a high counter, a stiff door, a microchip cat flap.
- When you deal with a pet (Chapter 11).
- When you haul a Medium or Large prize into another room or out of the house, or eat a portion of the prize (Chapter 8).
- When you charm a human (that's always a Sweet roll).
- When **a human can see you** and you do anything but walk, sit, wash, stare, or go through an entrance that needs no roll (Chapter 5).

How many dice

Say what your cat does and how — Sneaky, Sweet, Savage or Streetwise — and the Storyteller tells you if it's plain, **Tricky** or **Hard**. Then count your dice:

COUNTING DICE

1. Start with your **approach** rating (1–4).
2. **+1** if one of your instincts suits what you're doing (your **Knack**; never more than +1).
3. **+1 for each cat helping** (at most +2). A helper is in the same room, uses its Action, and doesn't roll. When cats carry the prize together, the other carriers are helpers.
4. You can never have more than **5 dice**.
5. Now take dice away: **Tricky –1**, **Hard –2**; a pet you're dealing with takes its rating (the pet's number, 1–3); and on a **Sneaky** or **Sweet** roll, a watching human takes their **Attention** (only the highest, if several are watching).

If that leaves you with **0 or fewer**, you can still try: roll **two** dice and keep the **lower** one. It can't be better than a Scrape (even two 6s). A Push rerolls both dice.

Reading the dice

Roll your dice together and look at the **highest** one.

HIGHEST DIE	RESULT	WHAT HAPPENS
1, 2 or 3	Flop	It doesn't work, and you made a noise.
4 or 5	Scrape	It works, but you made a noise.
6	Clean	It works, quietly.
Two or more 6s	Purrfect	It works so smoothly that nobody minds: no Mood step, and you gain 1 Cattitude.

Noise brings humans to look (Chapter 6). A Flop means that cat can't try the same thing again this round (another cat can).

Push your luck

Once per roll, after you see the dice, you can **Push**: pick up every die that isn't a 6 and roll them again. Then read the dice again. The cat who rolled pays for it: **1 Cattitude**, or **1 step** on the Mood meter that roll fills (Chapter 5) — even if nobody saw. A step paid this way goes on with the roll's own steps, after the reroll, and it always lands — even if the reroll is a Purrfect, and a kid doesn't double it; a Flop's fuller meter is the one that was fuller before you pushed. That's what "at all costs" means: there is always a way to try harder, and it always costs something.

Cattitude

Every cat starts each robbery with **2 Cattitude** (3 in a gang of three) and can hold up to **5** (any more is lost). Cats can't share it, and anything left at the end of the robbery is lost.

GAIN 1 CATTITUDE WHEN YOU…	SPEND 1 CATTITUDE TO…
give in to a temptation (Chapter 7)	Push after you roll
roll a Purrfect	resist a temptation

Doing it together

When the gang does one thing together — hauling the box into the next room, heaving open a stiff door — one cat leads and rolls; up to two others help (+1 die each, and helping is their Action). The result counts for all of them, and the Mood moves once.

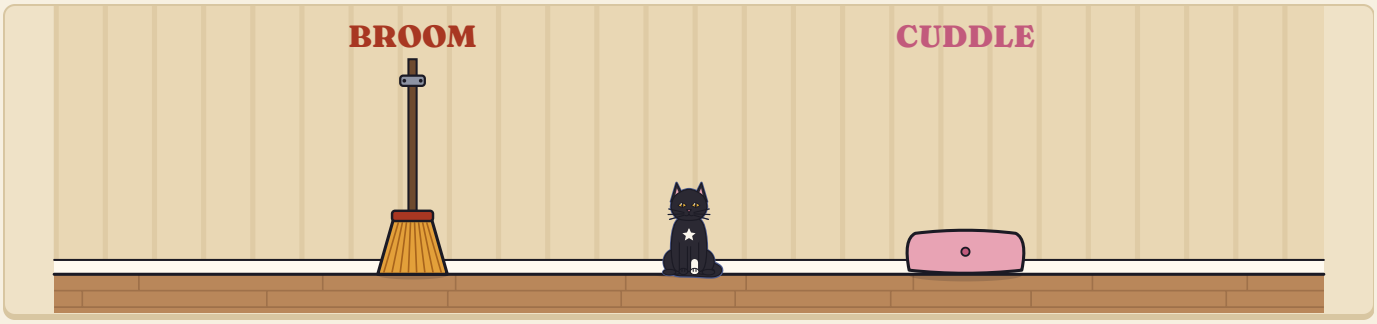
EXAMPLE

Big Biscuit wants to drive the Okafors' dog out of the kitchen. That's Savage (3), and he's a Scrapper, so +1: 4 dice. The dog's rating is 2, so 4 – 2 = 2 dice. He rolls 3 and 2 — a Flop. He Pushes for 1 Cattitude and rerolls both: 6 and 1. A 6: Clean. Biscuit puffs up to twice his size, and the dog runs to hide behind the sofa.

HOW LIKELY IS IT?

DICE	IT WORKS	CLEAN OR BETTER	PURRFECT
0 (keep the lower of 2)	1 in 4	never	never
1	1 in 2	1 in 6	never
2	3 in 4	1 in 3	1 in 36
3	7 in 8	2 in 5	1 in 14
4	15 in 16	1 in 2	1 in 8
5	31 in 32	3 in 5	1 in 5





CHAPTER 5

Seen, and the Mood

"Oh, hello! Whose cat are you? … Is that my chicken?"

A cat strolling through your kitchen is just a cat. A cat strolling through your kitchen with your chicken is a robbery. Humans don't mind cats wandering about — until a cat does something. That is the heart of this game: **being seen isn't being caught. Being seen doing something is.**

Who sees you

You are **seen** when you are in the same room as a human who is awake and isn't Distracted — and you aren't in a hiding spot. (A human holding a cat still sees you, but their hands are full: they can't chase or pick up anyone else until they let go.) Humans never see into the next room. Pets see too, but they don't fill the Mood: the dog has its own ways of making trouble (Chapter 11).

Hiding spots. Every room has somewhere to hide — under the sofa, behind the curtain, on top of the wardrobe — unless the house says it hasn't. Getting into one is a simple Action if nobody sees you, or a Sneaky roll if somebody does. You stay hidden until you move or do anything else. A cat holding the prize can't hide: there's a chicken sticking out from under the sofa.

Doing things in view

Walking, sitting, washing and staring are free, even right under a human's nose — and so is going in or out through an entrance that needs no roll (unless you're carrying the prize: Chapter 8). Helping another cat's roll is never a roll of its own. **Anything else you do while seen is a roll**, even things that are usually simple, like picking something up. Hiding in view is always a Sneaky roll; for everything else, choose how:

- **Sneaky** — do it without them noticing. Their Attention takes dice away, but a Clean Sneaky roll adds nothing to the Mood.
- **Savage** — just do it, fast. Their Attention doesn't matter, but they'll notice.
- **Sweet** — if what you're doing is charming them.

The Mood

The house has one **Mood** with two meters, kept on the house tracker. Each meter fills up to the house's **Patience** (4 to 8 in the houses in this book, a little more or less for three or five cats).

- **Broom** fills when humans see cats being naughty. When it's full, out comes the broom.
- **Cuddle** fills when humans see cats being sweet. When it's full, somebody gets picked up.

MOOD STEPS

When a human sees your roll:

- **Clean or Scrape:** 1 step. **Sweet** rolls fill **Cuddle**; Sneaky, Savage and Streetwise rolls fill **Broom**. A **Sneaky Clean** adds nothing — they never noticed.
- **Purrfect:** nothing.
- **Flop:** 2 steps on whichever meter is **fuller** (its own meter if they're level). A flop makes their mood worse: if they're already cross they get crosser, and if they're already soppy they want to pick you up.
- A kid who sees the roll — even a roll aimed at that kid — **doubles** Cuddle steps from it.
- One roll changes the Mood once, however many humans saw it.
- A meter never goes past full: steps beyond it are lost.

Some things add steps without a roll: at the start of a round, the Prize Clock finding the prize gone (Chapter 6) and a temptation given in to in view (Chapter 7); at the end of the house's turn (Chapter 6, *Finding it*), **+1 Broom** when a human finds a mess you left, when humans find the prize disturbed, and when a **Searching** human can see a cat.

A roll that fills a meter still does what it did — the door is open, the foil is off — but the Shoo! or Scoop happens before the cat goes anywhere.

Shoo!

When **Broom** fills, the human who saw it (the one with the highest Attention; still tied, roll a die) grabs the broom and chases that cat out through the **nearest entrance it fits through** that works this round (a front door only works in the rounds its house lists; Storyteller's pick if two are as near). If that entrance is shut, the human opens it to put the cat out. Then they shut it behind the cat (a cat flap or dog door gets locked: Streetwise, Hard, from inside to unlock it), **unless it's the house's last entrance still open** (a front door doesn't count), which they leave open. The human stays in the room that entrance is in for the rest of this round (they answer no noise). When a meter fills without a roll (a Searching human spots you, the prize or a mess is found), the Storyteller picks which cat that human can see gets it. The cat is outside. It can come back in through any entrance that's still open, next round at the earliest.

Scooped!

When **Cuddle** fills, the human who saw it (the one with the highest Attention; still tied, roll a die) picks that cat up. The cat is **Held** (Chapter 10). If the roll that filled Cuddle was a Distract, the Scoop wins: that human picks the cat up and isn't Distracted.

AFTER A SHOO! OR A SCOOP

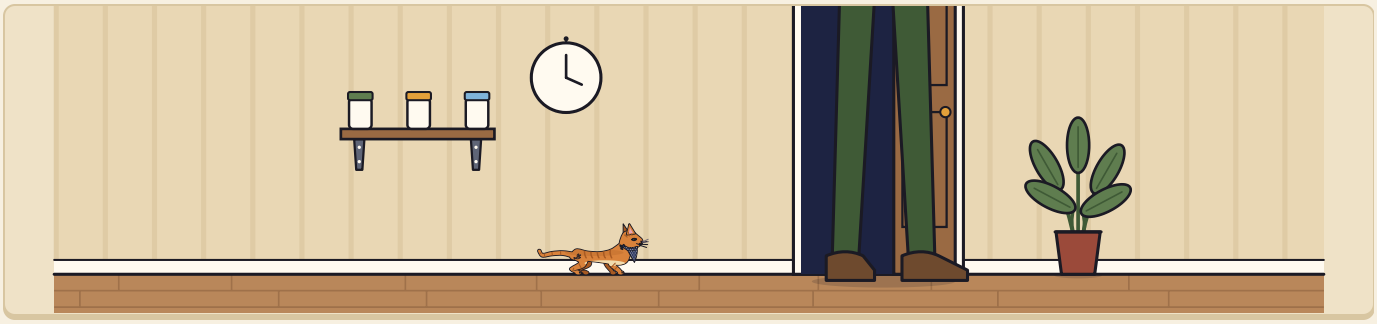
- **If the cat was carrying the prize**, it drops it: the human puts it back where the Prize Clock last put it, and every step of that spot has to be done again. Eaten portions stay eaten. (A cat caught by the very roll that picked the prize up was carrying it.) If the cat wasn't carrying it, the prize stays as it is.
- That meter empties to 0.
- **Patience drops by 1** (never below 2). The house is getting fed up.
- The other meter stays where it is — but if it's now at or above the new Patience, it drops to **one below**. (One catch never sets off the other straight away.)
- If a meter fills and no human with free hands can see a cat, it stays full until one can; then that human (the highest Attention; ties, a die) acts at once, and the Storyteller picks which cat they can see gets it. While it waits, steps on it are lost. If both meters are full and waiting, Broom goes first.
- A held cat whose own roll fills Broom is put outside: the holder lets go and shoos it out, as above.

Reading the room

Because the meters fill separately, the gang can steer. If Broom is nearly full, be sweet for a while; if Cuddle is nearly full, keep the Charmer out of sight and let the Muscle work. Watch both meters, and remember that Patience only ever goes down.

EXAMPLE

The Okafors' house has Patience 8. Mrs Okafor is in the living room with the box. Velvet distracts her with a slow blink (Sweet, Clean): Cuddle 1. Pip, carrying the box with Biscuit and Mags past Tayo in the hall, rolls a Scrape: Broom 1. Later Mags flops a Sneaky roll in front of Tayo. The meters are level (1 and 1), so the Flop goes on its own meter: Broom +2, now 3. Tayo is a kid, but he only doubles Cuddle steps.



CHAPTER 6

A Round in the House

A robbery is played in rounds. In each round every cat gets a turn, and then the house takes one: the humans wander, the dog sniffs about, and the prize gets closer to being eaten, played with or thrown out. It gets loud. It gets messy. That's the job.

A ROUND

1. **The Prize Clock.** If this round is on the house's Prize Clock, the human puts the prize in its place and stays with it this round — they answer no noise until the next round. If the prize isn't where the Clock last put it — and a prize the cats are holding never is — the human goes to where the Clock last put it instead, stays, and finds it gone at once: Broom +1, and they start Searching (if they weren't already).
2. **Temptation.** The Storyteller may tempt one cat (Chapter 7). If it gives in, it goes first this round.
3. **Cats.** Every cat takes a turn, in any order you like: **one Move** and **one Action**, either way round. Cats outside can come in. Held and shut-in cats can only try to get free (Chapter 10).
4. **The house.** Pets, then noise, then the humans' routines and anyone holding a cat, then *Finding it*.

Your turn: a Move and an Action

A Move takes you into the next room through an open way, or in or out through an entrance. Walking is never a roll.

An Action is one roll, or one simple thing. Simple things need no roll when no human can see you: pick something up, put it down, hide, or **make a noise** on purpose (that's a noise whatever you roll). Seen, any of them is a roll (Chapter 5). **Helping** another cat's roll is also your Action, but never a roll. **Eating a portion** of the prize is always a roll (Chapter 8).

Opening a closed door is an Action (the house says how hard). Going through an entrance that needs a roll takes your Move *and* your Action. Going *out* through one that needs no roll can be your Move or your Action, so a cat can walk to the cat flap and out in one turn. A cat can't go out and come back in on the same turn. An entrance's roll is made in the doorway: humans in the room it leads into see it. A roll to open a door inside the house is seen from the room the cat is in.

Doors. Humans and pets pass closed doors as if they were open (a dog noses through behind somebody) and leave them as they found them. Noise carries through them.

Noise

A Scrape or a Flop makes noise. So do noisy entrances such as cat flaps, barking dogs, squawking parrots, and a cat who knocks something over on purpose. In the house's turn, each noise draws the **closest awake human within two rooms** (the next room, or the one beyond it) who isn't already in that room, isn't holding a cat, and isn't staying put this round (with the prize the Clock just moved, or by the entrance they just shooed a cat out of). They go straight there, see only that room, and stay there instead of following their routine. Deal with noises in the order they happened; several noises in one room count as one; each human answers only one. If two humans are as close, the one with the higher Attention goes; if that's tied too, the Storyteller picks.

Luring. Making a noise on purpose is a good way to pull a human out of the room you want — but not the one who has just put the prize down: they stay with it that round. A noise made on purpose leaves a **mess** (one per room, however many noises), and a human who ends the round in that room finds it: Broom +1. A mess is found once, then it's cleared.

Distract

A Sweet roll aimed at a human in your room. If it works, that human is **Distracted** until the house's turn starts: they see nobody, so the rest of the gang can work right under their nose. It adds Cuddle steps as usual (if they fill Cuddle, the Scoop wins and the human isn't Distracted: Chapter 5). Each earlier distraction of that human that worked this robbery costs a die — a Lap Cat's fuss (Chapter 7) counts as one. When the house's turn comes they look round again — and if the prize has been touched and they're still in its room when that turn ends, they'll notice (*Finding it*).

The house's turn

1. **Pets.** A sleeping dog wakes if there was noise in its room or next door this round. An awake dog with a cat in its room barks (a noise) and stays put — unless the gang has befriended it; otherwise the Storyteller rolls its routine (Chapter 11). A dog that walks into a cat's room on its routine barks from next turn. A parrot that saw a cat that wasn't hidden at any time this round squawks (a noise).
2. **Noise**, as above.
3. **Routines.** The Storyteller rolls a d6 for each other human, reads their routine, and moves them straight to that room. They only see the room they end up in. A human who is **Searching** doesn't follow their routine (below).
4. **Holders** roll to see what happens to the cat they're holding (Chapter 10).
5. **Finding it** (below).

FINDING IT

At the end of the house's turn, in this order:

- **Spotted.** If a **Searching** human (not holding a cat) can see a cat: **Broom +1** (once a round, however many).
- **The prize.** The prize is **disturbed** if a step has been done, a portion eaten, or it isn't where the Clock last put it (an empty spot counts, even once the prize is outside or all eaten). Every awake human who isn't Searching yet or holding a cat, and is in the room the prize is in, or in the room where the Clock put it, finds it: **Broom +1** (once, however many) and they start **Searching**.
- **Messes.** A human in a room with a mess finds it: **Broom +1**, and the mess is cleared.

Searching

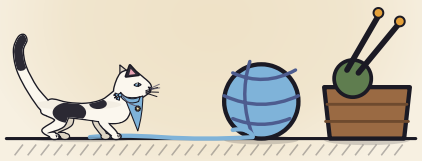
A Searching human knows something is up, and stays that way for the rest of the robbery. In the house's turn, instead of rolling their routine, they:

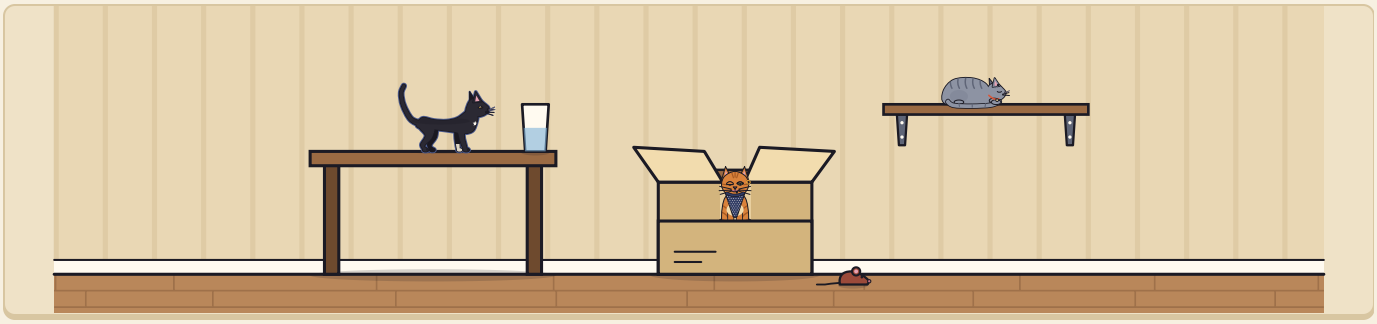
1. while the prize is still inside (a prize that's all eaten isn't): stay put if it's in their room, or step into its room if it's next door (a Searching human still answers noise first);
2. otherwise stay put if they can see a cat, or step into a next room where a cat isn't hiding (a cat shut in the Den doesn't count);
3. otherwise roll their routine as usual.

So once a human is Searching, don't let them catch you standing about: hide, keep moving, or keep the prize away from them.

KEEP IT MOVING

Most turns are short: "I leg it to the kitchen and hide under the table." Let the crew argue about the plan, but when a round drags, start the house's turn — humans don't wait.





CHAPTER 7

Instincts

Even the toughest cat on the street can't help itself. There is a glass on the edge of the table. There is a box. Something moved. Something sparkled. Every cat has two **instincts**: things it's brilliant at, and things it simply cannot walk past.

Knacks

When what you're doing suits one of your instincts, roll **+1 die**. That's your **Knack**. You only ever get one Knack die on a roll, even if both instincts fit.

Temptation

Each room in a house lists its temptations — the cake on the side, a basket of washing, a dangling string — and which instincts they tempt. And every house has **shiny things** lying about — keys, coins, a ring by the sink — so in any room a Curious or Knocker cat can be tempted by one. Its **catnip stash** tempts every cat in its room, whatever its instincts (Chapter 9). At the start of each round, the Storyteller may **tempt one cat** who is free, inside the house, and in a room with a temptation for one of its instincts, naming the cat and the temptation. (Only one cat per round, however big the gang, and never the same cat two rounds running.) Any room with an awake dog or house cat in it tempts Scrappers. A cat that has to deal with a pet in its room this turn (Chapter 11) can't be tempted, except a Scrapper by that pet: giving in, it squares up (a noise), which isn't dealing with it, so it is chased back the way it came at the end of its turn. The tempted cat decides at once; if it gives in, it takes its turn **first** this round, before any other cat.

The tempted cat chooses:

- **Give in.** Gain **1 Cattitude**. Your Action this round is the instinct thing, done right away, in that room, before you move. It is never a roll. If you were carrying the prize, you drop it there first (the other carriers let go too). Giving in never sets off a Shoo! or a Scoop: if its Mood step would fill a meter, the meter stops one short.
- **Resist.** Spend **1 Cattitude**. If you have none, you must give in.

INSTINCT	KNACK: +1 DIE TO…	TEMPTED BY…	GIVING IN	SEEN?
Curious	open, search, figure things out	a bag, a drawer, something new or shiny	You rummage in it. Noise.	+1 Broom
Knocker	knock, push, topple	something on the edge of a table — especially if it sparkles	You knock it off. Noise — and, if nobody saw it fall, a mess for whoever comes to look.	+1 Broom (and no mess)
Box Sitter	hide	a box, a bag, a basket	You get in. Quiet, and you're hidden.	—
Hunter	pounce, chase (not fighting animals)	anything that moves	You chase it round the room. Noise.	—
Lap Cat	charm a human	a lap, a sunny spot, a hand to rub	You go for a fuss. You pick a human in the room: they're Distracted until the house's turn (it counts as a distraction of them). No human? A sunny spot: quiet.	+1 Cuddle (+2 for a kid)
Foodie	find, steal and eat food	food that isn't the prize	You eat it. Quiet.	+1 Broom

INSTINCT	KNACK: +1 DIE TO…	TEMPTED BY…	GIVING IN	SEEN?
Climber	climb, jump, balance	somewhere high	You go up there. Quiet, and you're hidden.	—
Scrapper	face down and fight animals	an awake dog or cat	You square up to it. Noise. (That isn't dealing with it: you're chased back.)	+1 Broom

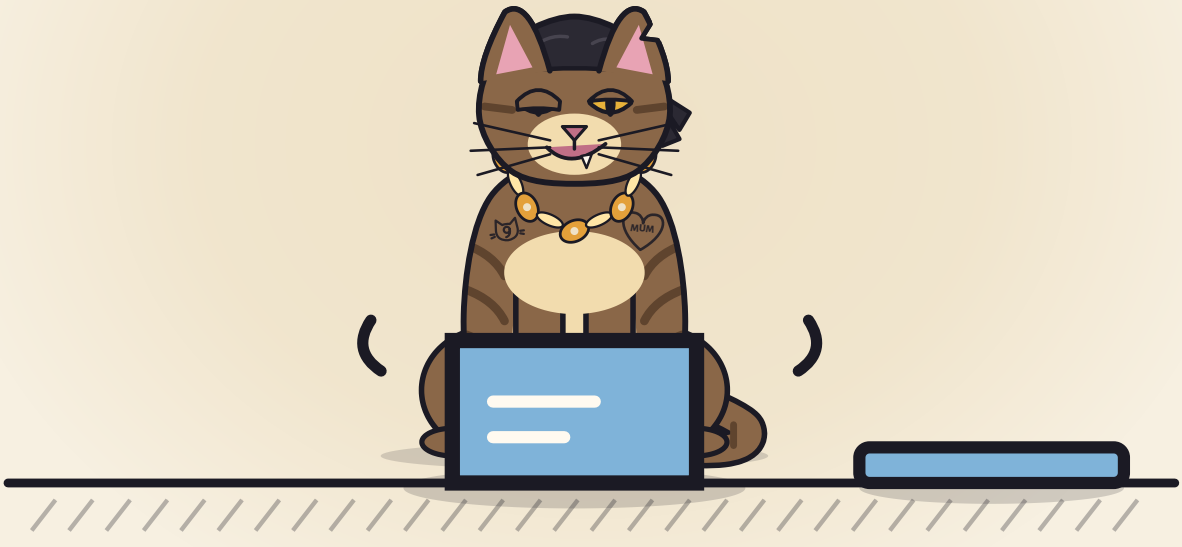
The **Seen?** column is what giving in adds to the Mood if a human sees it. Chasing a fly or climbing a bookcase looks like ordinary cat business; eating the dog's dinner doesn't.

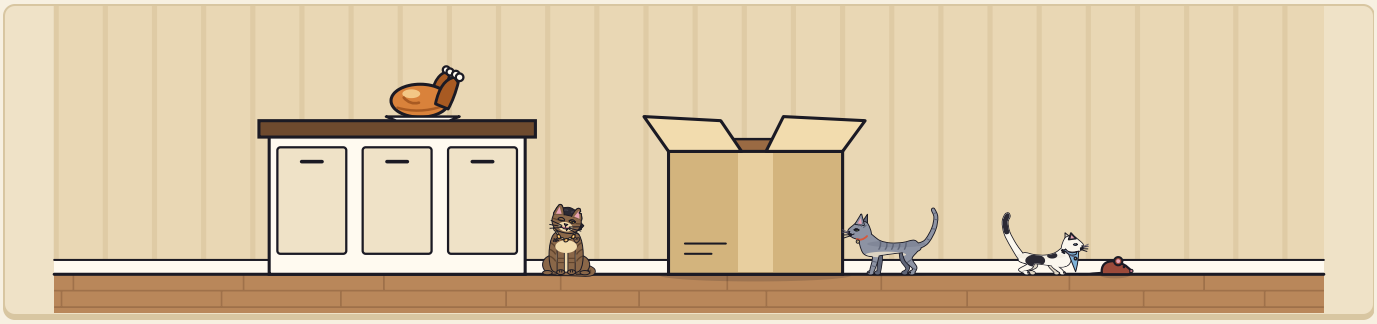
WHY GIVE IN?

Chaos pays. Giving in costs your Action and makes trouble, but it pays for the Cattitude that makes your important rolls work. A Lap Cat giving in at the right moment is a free distraction; a Box Sitter giving in is a free hiding place. The Storyteller will pick the worst moment to tempt you. Pick the best moment to say yes.

TEMPTING FAIRLY

Tempt the cat whose temptation makes the best story, but don't tempt the same player every round. You name the cat and the temptation; if you can't choose, roll for it among the cats who could be tempted. Late in the robbery, tempt the cat who can't pay: resisting is cheap for a cat about to lose its Cattitude anyway.





CHAPTER 8

Get In, Grab It, Get Out

You saw it go in. Now you go in after it, grab it and get back out — the whole crew — before it's eaten, put away or flattened for the recycling.

Getting in

The robbery starts with every cat **outside**. Each house has three or four **entrances**, and its map lists them: where each leads, how big it is, and what it takes to get through.

- Going through an entrance, in or out, is your **Move**. If the entrance needs a roll (a climb up the drainpipe, a cat flap to jam open), that roll is your **Action** too. Going out through one that needs no roll can be your Move or your Action.
- A **noisy** entrance (a rattling cat flap) makes a noise every time a cat goes through it.
- A **climb** entrance (a window up the drainpipe) takes nothing bigger than Small.
- Cats can split up and use different entrances.
- **The front door** only works while the human is coming in (round 1 in most houses), and only **one** cat a round gets through before it shuts: slip past their legs (Sneaky, Hard) or say hello (Sweet, plain), in view of the human the house names. A try that fails uses it up for that round.
- **Meow at a door** (Sweet) where a human is, and they open it and let you out. Any entrance that is a door counts — the front door in any round, a back, patio or garage door, a door with a cat flap in it — but not a window, a skylight or a climb. Not with your mouth full: a cat carrying something can't be Sweet.
- A shut entrance — the window someone closed after a Shoo! — can be opened again from inside (Streetwise, Hard).

Ways through the house

Rooms join by **ways**: doorways, stairs, gaps. A way is **Tight** (Lean cats only, and Small things), **Normal** (any cat; things up to Medium) or **Big** (anything). A closed door has to be opened first: usually Streetwise, Tricky (jump for the handle) or Savage, Hard (shove).

The prize

Before the robbery the Storyteller decides what the human carried in, or rolls a d8: **1–2 delicious, 3–4 fun, 5–6 shiny, 7–8 a box**, then a d6 on that table. Shiny things are carried out like fun things — cats love shiny things. The ready-to-run houses in Part Four each have their own.

D6	DELICIOUS	FUN	SHINY	A BOX
1	a rotisserie chicken (Medium)	a catnip mouse (Small)	a gold ring (Small)	a delivery box (Large)
2	a whole salmon (Medium)	a ball of wool (Small)	a wristwatch (Small)	a shoebox (Medium)
3	a birthday cake (Medium)	a feather wand (Small)	a bunch of car keys (Small)	a box of new trainers (Medium)
4	a bag of prawns (Small)	a squeaky ball (Small)	a silver spoon (Small)	a pizza box, empty (Medium)
5	a pack of ham (Small)	a laser pointer (Small)	sparkly earrings (Small)	a cat bed, still in its box (Large)
6	a tray of sausages (Medium)	a toy bird with a bell (Small)	a jewellery box (Medium)	a box with a new kettle in it (Medium)

WHERE IT GOES

The prize starts in the human's arms, and nobody can take it from them. Until the Clock first puts it down, the human carrying it answers noise and follows their routine as usual, prize and all. The house's **Prize Clock** says which round it's put down, where, when it's moved, and the round it's **gone** — eaten, put in a drawer, or flattened for the recycling. When the Clock moves it, the human who moves it stays with it for the round, whatever noise the gang makes.

If the prize isn't where the Clock last put it when the Clock says to move it — and a prize the cats are holding never is, even in that room — the human goes to where the Clock last put it instead, stays, and finds it gone at once: **+1 Broom**, and they start **Searching** (if they weren't already).

Humans notice a prize that's been touched. At the end of every house's turn, anyone beside a disturbed prize finds it (Chapter 6, *Finding it*). Distracting the human by the counter buys you a round of work — but if they're still there when the house's turn ends, they'll notice.

GETTING AT IT

A prize's spot can take several **steps**: up on the counter, then the foil off. Each step needs one roll that works, by any cat in the room. A step done stays done for the whole gang. Nobody can pick up or eat the prize until every step is done. Getting the prize down from its spot isn't climbing.

TAKING IT

SIZE	WHO CAN CARRY IT	WHERE IT FITS
Small	any one cat, in its mouth	anywhere
Medium	one Chonky cat, or two cats	Normal and Big ways; no climbing
Large	three cats, or two if one is Chonky	Big ways only; no climbing

Each carrier picks it up as its Action. After that they **hold** it without spending Actions, until they put it down, give in to a temptation, are Shooed or are Scooped. Carriers move together, using their Moves, and a cat holding the prize **can't hide**. A cat with its mouth full can't be Sweet.

HAULING

Moving a **Medium or Large** prize into another room, or out through an entrance, is a **roll every time**, seen or not: it's heavy, it bumps, it scrapes along the floor. A **Small** prize only needs the roll when a human in either room can see it; moved where nobody sees, the carrier just walks.

- It is every carrier's Action for the round. One carrier rolls **Sneaky** (quietly) or **Savage** (heave). The other carriers are its helpers, and any other cat in the room may help too (+1 die each, and it's their Action; still +2 at most); only the carriers move with the prize. It's plain unless the house says otherwise, and pushing is a Knocker's Knack. A human in either room — the one it leaves or the one it enters — sees it.
- If the entrance has its own roll (jam the flap, climb), that is the roll.
- It works: the carriers move, prize and all, and any noise is in the room it ends up in (a haul out of the house makes its noise in the room it left, like a cat going out through a noisy entrance). A Flop: it doesn't budge.
- Hauling out of an awake dog's room counts as leaving it (the dog takes no dice off the haul); if the haul fails there, the dog chases the carriers back the way they came and they drop the prize where they end up. Hauling into an awake dog's room uses the carriers' Actions, so they stay and deal with the dog first thing next turn.
- If the leader is Shooed or Scooped, the haul fails: the others let go, and the prize goes back where the Clock last put it.

EATING IT

Delicious prizes come in **portions**, set by the house per cat in the gang. Eating one is an Action and **always a roll**, seen or not: Sneaky to eat it quietly, Savage to wolf it down — a Foodie gets its Knack either way. It's plain unless the house says otherwise. You can carry food out instead, but eating is usually the surer plan: every haul is a roll too, and a cat carrying the prize can't hide.

Getting out

The prize is **gone** at the start of its Clock's last round — unless a cat is holding it then, and it stays the gang's to get out (if they put it down again after that, it's gone). **Lights Out** falls at the end of the second round after that: the humans have called animal control, and **any cat still inside — held, shut in, or free — is pinched** when the van arrives.

The robbery in the house ends at Lights Out — or sooner, at the end of a round, if no free cat is inside and either the prize is out, eaten or gone, or the gang outside decides to run for it. Any cat still inside then is pinched. **Don't run while a friend is held or shut in:** wait for the holder to put it down, or go back in for it (Chapter 10). Then comes the getaway (Chapter 9) — and that's where you find out how it went.



CHAPTER 9

The Getaway

"It's the Five-O! Leg it! LEG IT!" — Pip, every single time

Getting the loot is half the job. Getting it home is the other half: over the fences, dropping bits as you go, while the Five-O — the animal control warden, a harried human with a net and a van — puffs along behind. Get pinched and it's the pound.

When it starts

When the robbery in the house ends (Chapter 8), the getaway starts. Any cat still inside — held, shut in or free — is **pinched**: the humans have called animal control, and the warden collects it when the van pulls up. Every other cat is outside, and the whole gang runs for it. No loot to carry? Still run for it (a cornered cat can be pinched, and there's Cred to win), but keep it quick.

The route

Every house has a **getaway route**: four obstacles between its garden and the gang's hideout. Part Four prints one for each house; for your own, roll on the table below. It has five spaces: the **garden** (where the cats start and the van pulls up), **past 1**, **past 2**, **past 3** and the **hideout**. A cat's next obstacle is the one in front of its space.

The loot

Whatever the gang got out of the house is **loot**, and it comes in pieces. Food comes in its portions (whatever wasn't eaten inside). Anything else is **1 piece** if Small, **2** if Medium, **3** if Large: the box, and whatever was in it. Portions eaten in the house are already safe — the best place to hide food is inside a cat.

Share the pieces out: each cat carries **one piece**, a Chonky cat **two**. Pieces nobody can carry are left in the garden.

A GETAWAY ROUND

1. **Cats.** Each cat takes a turn, in any order. It tries to get over the **next obstacle** (a roll, as the route says), helps a cat on its space (one leads and rolls, up to two help, and the helpers go over with it), picks up a piece of loot dropped on its space, or waits where it is (no roll).
   - **It works:** over you go, onto the next space, helpers and all. Over the fourth, you're home with whatever you carry.
   - **A Flop:** you're all stuck there this round, and every carrier in the group drops a piece on that space.
2. **The warden.** At the end of round 2 the van pulls up on the garden and the warden jumps out (round 3 if nobody was Shooed or Scooped tonight: the humans took their time calling). At the end of every round after that he moves **1 space — 2** if any cat's roll ended in a Flop this round (not one saved by a Push): the racket gives you away. He **never passes a cat**: he stops on the space of the rearmost cat still running.
3. **Cornered.** A cat on the warden's space at the end of the round must **dodge**: Sneaky (slip between his boots), Savage (bolt) or Sweet ("I'm somebody's cat!"), plain. It works: the net swishes past and the warden goes sprawling over a bin; the cat stays where it is (a dodge never carries it over an obstacle), and he doesn't move next round. A Flop: **pinched** — in the van, loot and all. A dodge is each cat's own roll: nobody helps, and loot costs no die. A sprawled warden stays put next round even after a Flop (once, however many cats dodged), and a cat still on his space at the end of that round must dodge again. Any loot lying on his space is gone.
4. The getaway ends when every cat is home or pinched.

Running with the loot

A group **loses 1 die** if any cat in it carries loot (a Chonky cat with a single piece doesn't count; like Tricky, it comes off after the cap of 5), but carrying doesn't stop a cat helping. Before the roll, carriers can **drop a piece** on purpose to lose that die; it lies on that space for a friend to grab — if the warden doesn't get there first. A cat carrying loot has its mouth full: it can't be Sweet (Chapter 8) unless it drops its loot first, on purpose, as part of that roll.

Nobody's watching from a window out here, so getaway rolls fill **no meters**. A Push still works, paid with Cattitude only; a Purrfect still gives 1 Cattitude, and one you Pushed for still counts for Cred. Knacks count as usual: a Climber for fences and walls, a Hunter for bolting (a Savage crossing or dodge), a Box Sitter for hiding, a Lap Cat for charming. A pet on the route takes its rating off the roll as usual (Chapter 11): every cat or group rolls to get past it, and beating it only gets that group past. A Flop there is like any Flop: stuck, not chased back.

Pinched

A pinched cat goes to the **pound**. In a one-off robbery its night is over; in a campaign it can spend a **Life** to bust out (Chapters 10 and 14).

How did it go?

Count against the **whole prize** (all its portions, or all its pieces): what made it home, plus any portions eaten in the house.

OUTCOME	WHEN
Clean Getaway	All of the prize is home or eaten, and nobody was pinched.
Messy Getaway	At least half of it (round up) — or all of it, but somebody was pinched.
Busted	Less than half.

Cred: showing off

Any bunch of cats can nick a chicken. A *gang* leaves its mark. Showing off scores **Cred** for the cat who did it; keep it on your cat sheet. Cred never changes how the night went, only who gets to brag about it.

SHOWING OFF	CRED
Tag a room: leave the gang's mark (a cheek-rub on the telly, a tuft of fur on the best cushion, a muddy paw-print tag on the fridge). One tag a room for the whole gang.	1
…while a human watches, and it works	+1
…over the rival gang's tag	+1
Get into the catnip (the house's stash)	1
Lead a group past the rivals with a Clean or a Purrfect (each group's leader; a cat on its own counts)	1
A Purrfect on any getaway obstacle (what a leap)	1
Anything you score with the zoomies	×2

Tagging is your Action. Unseen, it's a simple thing: no roll, no noise. In view it's a roll, Sneaky or Savage, plain; if it works, that's the extra Cred, even on a Sneaky Clean (they saw the mark appear and never saw who did it). A tag nobody saw is a **mess**: a human who ends a round in that room finds it (+1 Broom, Chapter 6). That cleans up the mess, not the Cred, and the room stays tagged. A tag made in view isn't a mess (they already know; the roll's Mood step is the price). Smart gangs tag on the way out.

The catnip stash. Every house has one, and the house says where. It **tempts every cat** in its room, whatever its instincts (it's still the Storyteller's one temptation a round); giving in works like a Curious cat rummaging (a noise, and +1 Broom if a human sees). Or a cat goes for it on purpose, as its Action (in view, a Sneaky or Savage roll, plain). Either way the cat rolls about in it, yowling (a noise, not a mess), and scores 1 Cred (that one isn't doubled). There's one stash, so only one cat gets it, and then it tempts nobody. That cat gets **the zoomies**, which wear off when the getaway starts, even for a cat that's already outside:

- **+1 die** on every roll (still no more than 5);
- **every roll it makes is a noise**, even a Clean (a Sneaky Clean still adds nothing to the Mood: they heard a yowl and saw nothing);
- a **tag is always a roll** (Sneaky or Savage, plain), seen or not;
- it **can't resist** a temptation, and everything it scores counts double.

The rivals. Every house is on some other gang's patch, and the house names them. They've tagged one room, and tagging over theirs is worth a point more. On the getaway they hang about on one obstacle. Any loot dropped by a cat trying to get over it is **nicked at once** (gone), and the cat who leads a group over it with a Clean or a Purrfect scores 1 (on top of a Purrfect's leap). That showed them.

The Cat's Whiskers. At the end of the night, the cat with the most Cred is the Cat's Whiskers: bragging rights, the warm spot on the boiler, and the last word on which house is next. Ties share it, and argue. In a campaign, a night when the **gang's Cred adds up to 8 or more**, and that wasn't Busted, is worth 1 Rep (Chapter 14).

A route for your own house

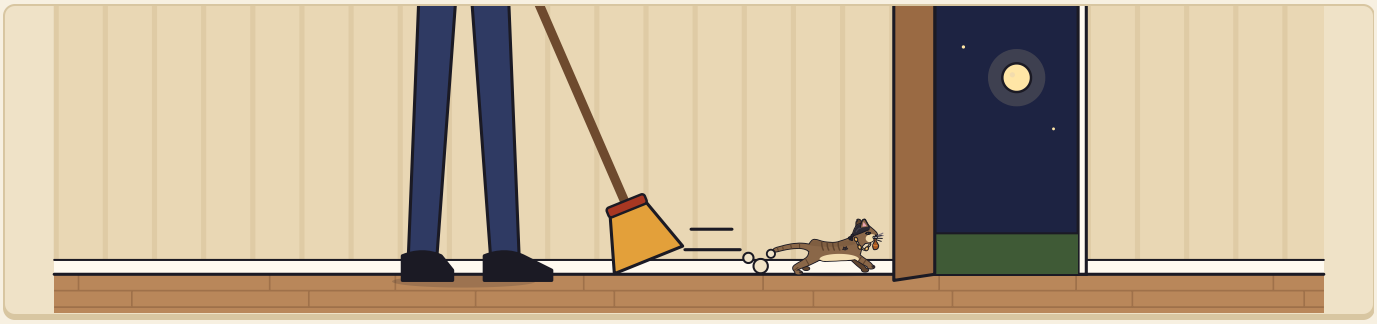
Roll a d6 four times, or pick. An Easy house has plain obstacles; a Hard one has two or three Tricky ones.

D6	OBSTACLE	ROLL
1	A garden fence	Savage or Sneaky, plain (a Climber's Knack)
2	A hedge, or a row of bins	Sneaky or Savage, plain
3	A high wall	Savage or Sneaky, Tricky (a Climber's Knack)
4	A yard dog	rating 1–2: Savage drives it off, Sneaky slips past, Sweet befriends a soft one
5	A greenhouse or a shed roof	Sneaky or Streetwise, Tricky
6	A road	Streetwise or Savage, plain or Tricky (a Hunter's Knack to bolt)

MAKE IT A CHASE

This is the loud bit. Slam the van doors. Have the warden yell "Oi!" When a cat Flops, the chicken leg bounces into the gutter. When the last cat drops into the hideout, let the table cheer.





CHAPTER 10

Caught!

"Name?" "Biscuit." "Full name?" "Big. Biscuit." — at the pound, Tuesday night

GETTING CHASED OUT WITH A BROOM IS BAD FOR A TOUGH cat's image, but you can always come back in another way. Getting **picked up** is worse. Humans who pick up cats tend to keep them.

Held

When Cuddle fills, a human picks the cat up. A **Held** cat can't move, and drops anything it was carrying. While the human is holding a cat they stay where they are: they don't follow their routine, answer noise or Search, and they don't find things. But they still see everything in their room.

On its turn a held cat can **wriggle free** (Savage, Tricky; Chonky cats get +1 die; cats in the same room can help). If it works, the cat drops to the floor in that room, seen. Or it can go limp and purr, and let the gang get on with it.

In the house's turn (after the routines), the human holding a cat rolls a d6:

D6	WHAT THE HUMAN DOES
1–3	Keeps cuddling.
4–5	Carries the cat to the **Den** — the house's spare room or bathroom — and shuts it in, "just until we find your owner". The human stays just outside, in the room next to the Den's door, for the rest of this round.
6	Puts the cat out through the nearest entrance that works this round (it stays open): "Go on, home you go."

Shut in

A cat a human shuts in the Den is **Shut In**; its door stays shut while it's inside. A cat that walks into the Den on its own isn't shut in. A friend in the next room can open it (Streetwise, Tricky — jump for the handle). Alone, the cat needs Streetwise, Hard. Once it's open, the cat is free.

Pinched

Any cat still inside when the robbery in the house ends — held, shut in or free — is pinched. The humans have rung animal control, and the warden carries it out to the van. So is a cat the warden catches in the getaway (Chapter 9). A pinched cat goes to the **pound**: a cage, a bowl, a blanket, and a lot of time to sulk about what it did.

In a one-off robbery, while a cat is held or shut in, its player can play a resident if the Storyteller likes — the house cat, perhaps, who is delighted to see it go. In a campaign, read on.

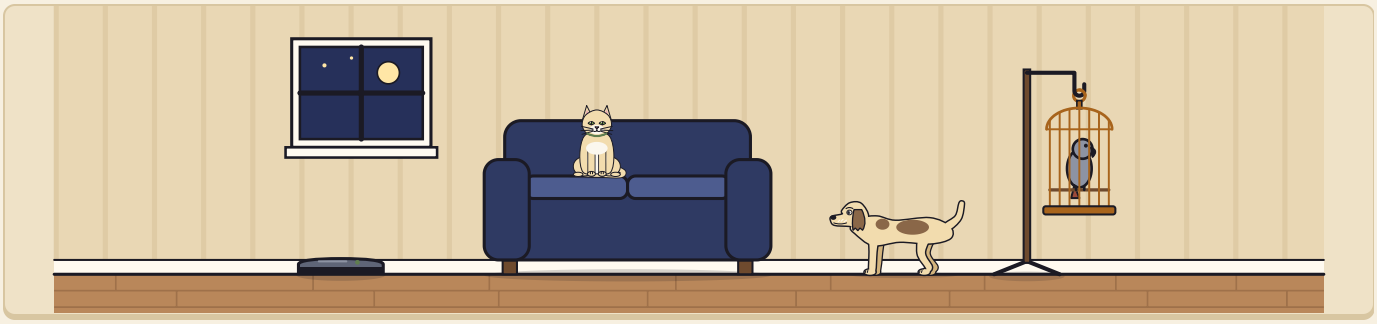
Don't all run while a friend is held or shut in. The robbery in the house ends at the end of any round when no free cat is inside and the gang has run for it (Chapter 8) — and then the friend still inside is pinched.

Nine Lives

Every cat has **9 Lives**. They only matter in a campaign (Chapter 14). When a cat is pinched, its player can spend a Life: the cat busts out of the pound in the night and is back with the gang by the next robbery. With no Lives left, somebody adopts it from the pound, and it retires to a cushion for ever.

CARTOON RULES

Play every catch as slapstick: the broom sweeps, the cat skids out of the door and lands on its feet; the scoop is all "ooh, look at you"; the net mostly catches bin lids. Nobody gets hurt. The worst that happens is the pound, and a lot of sulking.



CHAPTER 11

Who Lives There

Every house has its people and its pets, and every one of them has a routine. Learn it, and you can work round it. The Storyteller plays them all — fairly, by the dice.

Humans

Each human has an **Attention** of 0, 1 or 2: how hard they are to fool. When a human is watching, their Attention takes dice away from Sneaky and Sweet rolls (only the highest Attention counts if several are watching). Savage rolls ignore it — but Savage never goes unnoticed.

Each human has a **d6 routine**: six results, each "stays put" or a room. In the house's turn the Storyteller rolls for each human who didn't answer a noise and isn't Searching, and they go straight to that room. They only see the room they end up in.

TRAITS

TRAIT	WHAT IT DOES
Kid	Loves cats. Doubles Cuddle steps from any roll they see.
Dozes	Each round, on a 1–2 on an extra d6, falls asleep until the end of the next round: sees nothing, hears nothing, and stays put. Roll it every house's turn, even in a round they don't roll a routine. Only a Prize Clock job wakes them.
Busy	Too busy cooking (or working) to answer noise. Still sees everything in the room.
Headphones	Doesn't answer noise. Usually a teenager.

SEARCHING

A human who finds the prize disturbed — beside it at the end of the house's turn, or sent by the Prize Clock to fetch it — adds +1 Broom and starts **Searching** for the rest of the robbery (Chapter 6). In the house's turn, instead of following their routine, a Searching human:

1. while the prize is still inside (a prize that's all eaten isn't): stays put if it's in their room, or steps into its room if it's next door (they still answer noise first); otherwise
2. stays put if they can see a cat, or steps into a next room with a cat who isn't hiding (a cat shut in the Den doesn't count; the Storyteller picks between rooms); otherwise
3. follows their routine as usual.

At the end of every house's turn, if a Searching human can see a cat, Broom goes up by 1. A human holding a cat isn't Searching while they hold it. Hidden cats aren't seen, so a Searching human walks right past them — but nobody can hide while holding the prize.

Pets

Pets have a **rating** of 1 to 3 (how many dice they take away when you deal with them) and a d6 routine like a human's. A routine result of **sniff** means the pet goes one room towards the nearest free cat inside the house (ties: the Storyteller picks). Pets don't fill the Mood; they make noise, and they get in the way. A pet that is **driven off** hides for 3 rounds, counting this one — put 3 tokens on it and take one off at the end of each round — then it's back in the room it started the robbery in, awake.

Dog
"Woof. WOOF. Woof woof."

RATING 1–3 **ROUTINE** d6: rooms, stays put, sniff

Asleep: Some dogs start asleep. A sleeping dog does nothing until there's been noise in its room or the next one; it wakes at the start of the house's turn and acts at once.

Bark: In the house's turn, an awake dog with a cat in its room barks (a noise, so a human may come) and stays put. Dogs smell hidden cats.

Charge: A cat that walks into an awake dog's room, or starts its turn there, must leave or deal with the dog before doing anything else; helping the cat who deals with it counts. A cat that ends its turn there without dealing with it is chased back the way it came (outside again, if it just came in) — unless it has no Action left (it climbed in, or gave in elsewhere): then it stays, and deals with the dog first thing next turn. Hauling the prize out counts as leaving.

Beat it: The roll loses dice equal to the dog's rating. **Savage** drives it off (it hides for 3 rounds, counting this one). **Sweet** befriends a *soft* dog: it leaves the whole gang alone for the rest of the robbery (no barking, no charging, and it doesn't tempt Scrappers; it still wanders). **Sneaky** slips past it for this turn. A Flop: the dog chases the cat who rolled back the way it came (that's not its Move; a carrier drops the prize).

House cat
"This is MY kitchen."

RATING 1–3 **ROUTINE** stays in its room

Guard: Guards one room, like a dog's Charge: a gang cat in that room must leave or deal with it before doing anything else (helping counts), and a cat that ends its turn there without dealing with it is chased back the way it came. It isn't fooled by hiding spots.

Beat it: As a dog: Savage drives it off, Sweet befriends a soft one, Sneaky slips past for this turn.

Parrot
"PRETTY BOY! CAT! CAT!"

RATING — **ROUTINE** never moves

Squawk: In the Pets step of the house's turn, if it saw a cat that wasn't hidden at any time this round, it squawks: noise in its room.

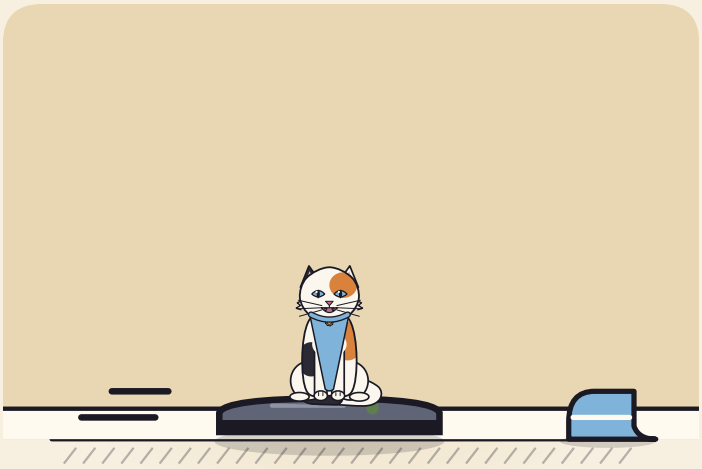
Beat it: Throw a cloth over its cage (Streetwise, Tricky): it goes quiet for the rest of the robbery.

Robot vacuum
"Bweep."

RATING — **ROUTINE** one room each round, at random

Wanders: In the Pets step of each house's turn it goes into a next room on its list (roll a die between them). It tempts Hunters in whatever room it's in.

Ride it: A cat can hop on (a simple Action): it moves with the vacuum and counts as hidden while it rides. Hopping off is free. A cat holding the prize can't ride.

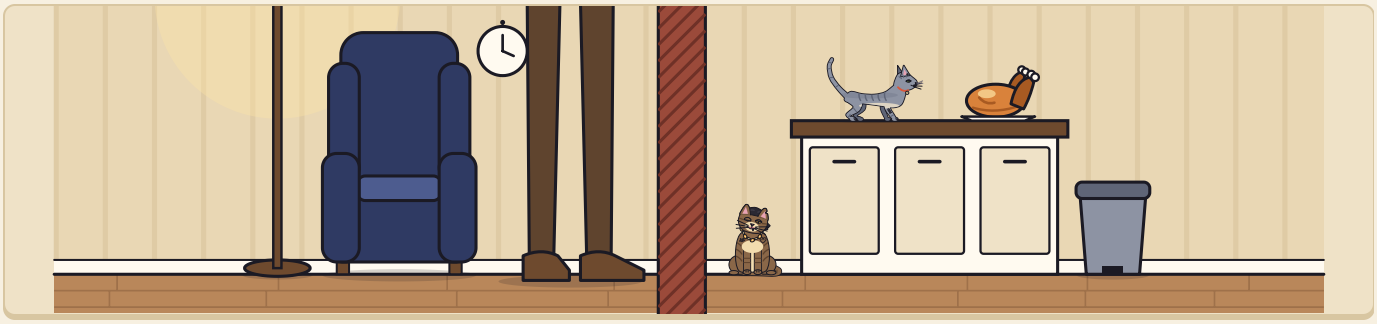


PART THREE

Running the House

For the Storyteller: how to play the humans, the pets, the Prize Clock and the Five-O — and how to build a house of your own for the gang to hit.





CHAPTER 12

The Storyteller

You are the house. You are the grown-up with the chicken, the kid who wants a kitten, the dog who has never once caught anything, the clock on the wall — and, at the end, the Five-O, puffing after the gang with a net. You don't try to beat the gang — the dice and the routines do that. Your job is to make the house feel alive, loud and fair.

Three promises

- **Play the routines straight.** Roll every human's and pet's routine in the open and do what the die says. The players should be able to plan around the house, and be surprised by it.
- **Say the stakes before the roll.** "That's Tricky, and Mr Pell is watching, so it fills Broom if he sees it." Nobody should be surprised by the rules.
- **Make it funny, never cruel.** Cats skid, slide, sneeze into the flour and crash into the recycling. Humans say "aww" and "HEY!". The tough talk is all talk, and nobody gets hurt (Chapter 10).

Before you start

1. Pick a house from Part Four, or make one (Chapter 13). Read its page and keep its tracker in front of you.
2. Set out the tracker: Patience (adjusted for gang size, below), the Mood meters at 0, the Prize Clock.
3. Read the start of the house aloud: the street, the house, the human going in with the prize.
4. Show the players the house page — the map and its **entrances**, who lives there, Patience and the Prize Clock. None of it is secret; the dice keep the surprises. They choose where each cat goes in.

Gang size

The houses are written for four cats. With one or two players, each player runs two cats, so the gang has at least three. For your own houses: with **three** cats, the house's Patience is 1 higher, the prize goes 2 rounds later, and each cat starts with 3 Cattitude; with **five**, Patience is 1 lower. Only the "Gone" row of the Prize Clock moves (and Lights Out with it). The ready-to-run houses print their own three- and five-cat numbers in *At a glance* — a few differ from this rule, because we tested each house — so use those. Food portions already count the cats.

EVERY ROUND, IN ORDER

1. **Prize Clock.** Does the prize get put down or moved this round? Its human goes there and stays, deaf to noise this round. (Not where the Clock left it, or in the cats' paws? The human goes there and finds it gone at once: +1 Broom, and they start Searching.) Is it gone this round?
2. **Tempt** one cat, or nobody (never the same cat two rounds running). If it gives in, it goes first.
3. **Cats act.** For each roll: who can see it? What does it need? Then update the meters.
4. **Pets:** wake sleeping dogs near noise; a dog with a cat in its room barks; a parrot that saw a cat squawks; roll the others' routines.
5. **Noise:** list this round's noises in order; move the closest human within two rooms to each (not one already there, holding a cat, or staying put this round).
6. **Routines:** roll for every other human. Searching humans hunt instead.
7. **Holders** roll.
8. **Finding it:** a Searching human sees a cat: +1 Broom. Anyone not yet Searching in the disturbed prize's room, or its Clock room: +1 Broom, and Searching. A mess found: +1 Broom.
9. Is it Lights Out? Is no free cat inside — and is the prize out, eaten or gone, or has the gang run for it? Then the house is done: anyone still inside is pinched, and the getaway starts.

EVERY GETAWAY ROUND, IN ORDER

1. **Cats:** over the next obstacle (a Flop: stuck, and carriers drop a piece), help, grab a dropped piece, or wait.
2. **The warden:** arrives on the garden at the end of round 2 (round 3 if nobody was Shooed or Scooped tonight); then moves 1 space a round, 2 after a Flop, never past a cat.
3. **Cornered:** cats on the warden's space dodge (plain; it works: they stay put and he skips his next move) or are pinched; loot there is gone.
4. Everyone home or pinched? Count against the whole prize.

Calling the roll

When a player says what their cat does, decide three things: **which approach** (they usually tell you), **how hard** (plain, Tricky or Hard — the house lists the hard bits), and **who can see it**. Then let them count their dice.

IT'S…	FOR EXAMPLE
Plain	a low chair, a door already ajar, a bag left open
Tricky (–1)	a kitchen counter, a lever handle, a stiff window, foil on a plate
Hard (–2)	the top of the fridge, a round doorknob, a drainpipe, a microchip cat flap

Ties. When the rules make you pick between humans — two as close to a noise, two who saw the same roll — the one with the higher Attention goes first. Still tied? Roll a die. Save your own choices for which cat a meter falls on and whom to tempt.

When the meters fill

Make Shoo! and Scooped! big moments. Stop, describe it, then do the bookkeeping: if the caught cat had the prize, put it back where the Clock left it; empty the meter; lower Patience by 1 out loud — the players should feel the house running out of patience — and if the other meter is now at or over Patience, drop it to one below.

Sometimes a gang lets one cat take the broom on purpose — taking one for the crew — so the others can finish the job while the house calms down. That's allowed, and it's a good story: the house still loses Patience for good, and the entrance the cat went out of is shut (unless it was the last one open).

YOUR FIRST ROBBERY

Run Number 12 (Chapter 15). Every round, say out loud where Mr Pell goes and why: a noise, the chicken, or his routine roll. When the chicken is put down, describe the foil crackling. When the first cat flops in front of Mr Pell, have him say "Oi!" (or "Aww!") and put the 2 steps on the fuller meter — the players learn the Mood in one go.

Young players

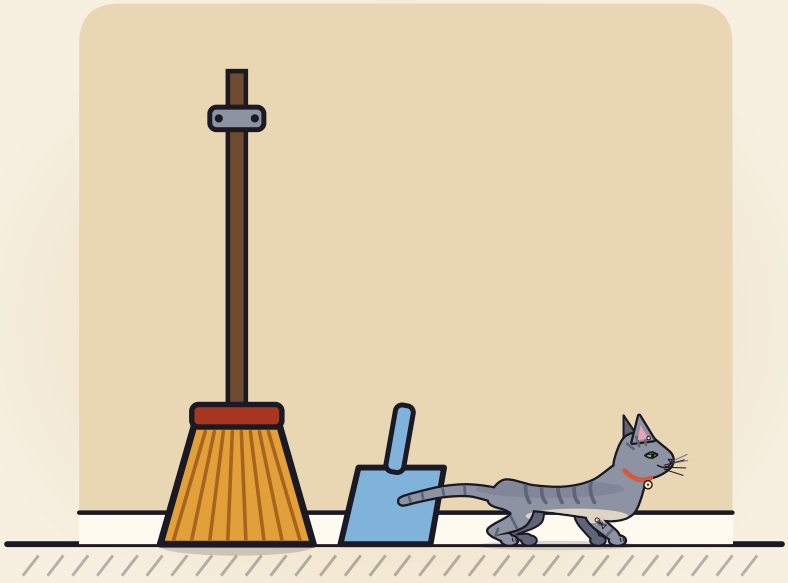
For players around eight: let them count their own dice, read the highest die together, and use tokens for Cattitude. Keep the map on the table and the cats on it as counters. Skip the lure details in the first robbery; teach Distract when the Charmer needs it.

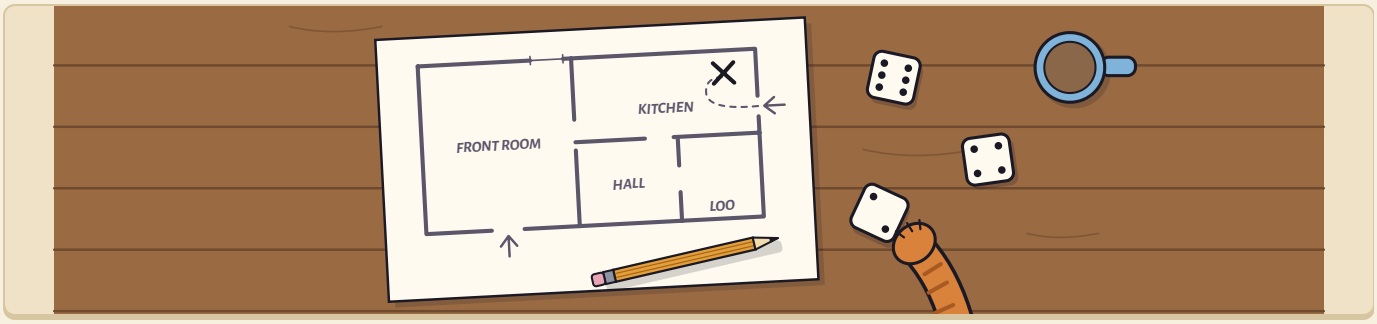
HOW HARD ARE THE HOUSES?

We played each house thousands of times with computer gangs that follow the rules exactly. A gang of four sensible players with rolled-up cats gets the prize (a Clean or Messy Getaway) about 9 times in 10 at an Easy house, 4 times in 5 at a Standard house, and a bit more than half the time at a Hard house. The ready-made gang does better, especially at Grandpa Wendell's. At the Hard houses a Clean Getaway is rare: eating half the cake and getting everyone out is a good night. About one Hard robbery in five ends with a cat adopted — one in four at Chef Marchetti's. Three or five players do about as well, using each house's own numbers for the gang's size.

QUESTIONS AT THE TABLE

- **Jumping for a door handle** — is that a Climber's Knack (jump) or a Curious one (open)? Either.
- **Can cats outside help one coming in?** No: a helper is in the same room, and outside isn't a room.
- **The Clock moves a prize the gang has dropped somewhere else.** The human goes to the old spot and finds it gone; the old spot is still "where the Clock last put it".
- **Does a held cat count as seen?** Yes: a Searching human who can see it adds +1 Broom, and a parrot squawks at it. So does a cat being chased through a room.
- **A cat shooed out — can it come straight back?** Not this round; next round, through any entrance still open.
- **Somebody's Cattitude got lost track of.** Use tokens, one pile per cat, and keep each cat's pile on its sheet.
- **Can cats help a Distract?** Yes, like any roll (+2 at most): two cats round the ankles are twice as distracting.
- **A cat one step short of a full Broom Flops on purpose.** Allowed: the human marches it out and the others get a free moment. It costs Patience and an entrance.
- **A cat pops out through a noisy flap to draw a human.** It works, but it still has to come back in, and every trip through the flap is another clack.





CHAPTER 13

Making a House

Every house on the street has a story: who lives there, what they just brought home, and why they left the kitchen window open. Here is how to build a house worth hitting, and one that plays well.

A HOUSE NEEDS

- **5 to 8 rooms**, with a map. Each room: its name, any hiding spots that are missing, and usually one or two temptations — the thing, and the instinct it tempts ("the fruit bowl: Knocker").
- **Ways** between rooms: their size, and any closed doors with how hard they are to open.
- **3 or 4 entrances** — never fewer than two — each with its room, size and what it takes. At least one should need no climbing, so a Medium or Large prize can get out.
- **A Den**: a room with a door, away from the entrances.
- **1 to 4 humans**, each with Attention, a trait if any, a start room and a d6 routine.
- **0 to 2 pets**, each with a start room, and a rating and a d6 routine if its kind has them (Chapter 11).
- **The prize**: what it is, its size, portions if it's food, and the **Prize Clock** — when it's put down, where, how many steps to get at it, when it moves, and the round it's gone.
- **Patience.**
- **A getaway route**: four obstacles from the garden to the hideout (Chapter 9 has a table).

Portions

A Small food is **1 portion per cat**. A Medium food is **1 per cat, plus 1 or 2**. A cake or something big is **2 per cat**.

Routines that make a house play

- Give most rooms a result on *some* routine. A room nobody ever visits becomes a safe place to wait, and waiting is boring — one quiet room (a loo, a spare bedroom) is fine; three is too many.
- Put the prize's room on the routine of the human who owns it at least twice.
- "Stays put" on 1–3 makes a human easy to plan around; on 1–2 they wander more.

How hard?

These are the knobs that matter most, from the simulations behind the houses in Part Four:

KNOB	EASIER	HARDER
Patience	higher for the number of humans: 4 with one human, 7–8 with two or three	1–2 lower than that
Prize Clock	gone on round 9–13	gone on round 8
The prize	food (eaten where it is), or something Small	a Large thing that has to be hauled through several rooms to one Big way

KNOB	EASIER	HARDER
Humans near the prize	one who wanders; Attention 0–1	a busy cook who never leaves, or three or more people; Attention 2
Pets	a soft dog, asleep	a rating-3 dog that roams the prize's rooms
Entrances	a free way in next to the prize	only climbs and microchip flaps

Patience only means something next to the humans: one human watching fills the meters slowly, so Number 12 can get away with Patience 4, while a party of four fills them fast. Our five houses use: **Easy** — Patience 4, one human, a soft dog, food, gone on round 10. **Standard** — Patience 7–8, two or three humans and a pet, a thing to carry out, gone on round 9–13 (the bigger the thing, the longer). **Hard** — Patience 6–7, several watchful humans or a busy cook and a big dog, food, gone on round 8.

Rolling a house

Short of ideas? Roll on these tables, then draw the map and adjust until it plays.

D6	THE HOUSE (ROOMS)	WHO LIVES THERE (ROLL 1–3 TIMES)
1	Little terrace: hall, living room, kitchen, utility room, loo	Grandparent: Attention 0, Dozes. 1–3 stays put, 4–5 living room, 6 kitchen.
2	Semi with a garage: hall, living room, kitchen, garage, landing, bathroom, bedroom	Busy parent: Attention 1. 1–2 stays put, 3–4 kitchen, 5 hall, 6 living room.
3	Cottage: hall, living room, kitchen, bathroom, bedroom	Kid: Attention 1, Kid. 1 stays put, 2–3 living room, 4 kitchen, 5 bedroom, 6 the prize's room.
4	Flat over a shop: stairs, landing, living room, kitchen, bathroom, bedroom	Teenager: Attention 0, Headphones. 1–4 stays put, 5 kitchen, 6 bathroom.
5	Family house: hall, living room, dining room, kitchen, landing, bathroom, bedroom	Cook: Attention 2, Busy. 1–5 kitchen, 6 hall.
6	Big old house: hall, living room, study, kitchen, cellar, landing, bedroom, bathroom	Neat freak: Attention 2. 1 stays put, 2 hall, 3 living room, 4 kitchen, 5 the prize's room, 6 bathroom.

D6	PETS	ENTRANCES (ROLL 3 OR 4 TIMES; REROLL REPEATS)
1–2	None	1 Front door (round 1, one cat). 2 Cat flap in the back door: Normal, no roll, makes noise.
3	A soft dog, rating 1, asleep	Window open over the sink, up the bins: Normal, climb, Sneaky or Savage, Tricky.
4	A dog, rating 2, awake	Dog door: Normal, no roll.
5	A house cat, rating 1–2, guarding the living room	Bathroom window over the shed roof: Normal, climb, Tricky.
6	A parrot, or a robot vacuum	Garage side door, left ajar: Big, no roll.

Give a dog a routine of rooms, "stays put" and "sniff". Put the prize where its owner's routine goes at least twice, make the Den a room with a door away from the entrances, then use the knobs above to set Patience and the Clock. Before the night, walk one cat round the map — in through each entrance, to the prize and out again with it — and check every way is big enough for the prize.

ROOM	TEMPTATIONS TO CHOOSE FROM
Kitchen	the fruit bowl on the edge (Knocker), the dog's dinner (Foodie), the top of the fridge (Climber)
Living room	a warm lap (Lap Cat), the top of the bookcase (Climber), a dangling blind cord (Hunter)
Hall and landing	shopping bags (Curious), a shoebox (Box Sitter), the stair rail (Climber)
Utility and garage	the washing basket (Box Sitter), a spider (Hunter), a sack of cat biscuits (Foodie)
Bedrooms, study, bathroom	the top of the wardrobe (Climber), a pen on the desk (Knocker), the loo roll (Hunter), a full laundry bag (Box Sitter)



CHAPTER 14

The Block

One job makes a great evening. A street full of houses makes a campaign: the gang gets a name, a reputation, a lot of big talk, and a list of humans who now lock their windows.

Playing a campaign

Each session is one robbery at one house on the Block. Draw a simple map of the street, and add houses as the gang hears about them: the five in Part Four, and any you make.

The gang's name

A campaign gang needs a name. Roll a d6 or pick: 1 the Bottle Cap Bandits, 2 the Lamppost Mob, 3 the Dustbin Dozen (however many you are), 4 the Midnight Yowlers, 5 the Sticky Paw Syndicate, 6 the Back Fence Crew.

What carries over

THING	BETWEEN ROBBERIES
Cattitude	Back to the starting amount each robbery: 2 (3 in a gang of three), plus the gang's Rep bonus.
Lives	Carry over. Spend one when a cat is pinched to bust it out of the pound before the next robbery.
Rep	The gang gets **1 Rep** for every Clean Getaway, and **1 Rep** for a night when the gang's Cred adds up to 8 or more, and that wasn't Busted (Chapter 9).
Houses	A house the gang has robbed before starts with **Patience 1 lower** (never below 2). They remember.

Rep

At **3, 6 and 9 Rep**, every cat in the gang starts each robbery with **1 more Cattitude** (never above 5). A cat who joins later gets the gang's bonus too. A gang with a big Rep is bolder, not stronger — so as the Rep grows, take it to harder houses.

Cats left in the pound

A cat pinched with no Lives to spend leaves the gang — somebody adopts it from the pound — and its player makes a new cat, with 9 Lives of its own. The old one isn't gone: it lives somewhere on the Block now. One day the gang may rob that very house — and meet a familiar face by the radiator, who might help them, or might not.

A cat's last Life

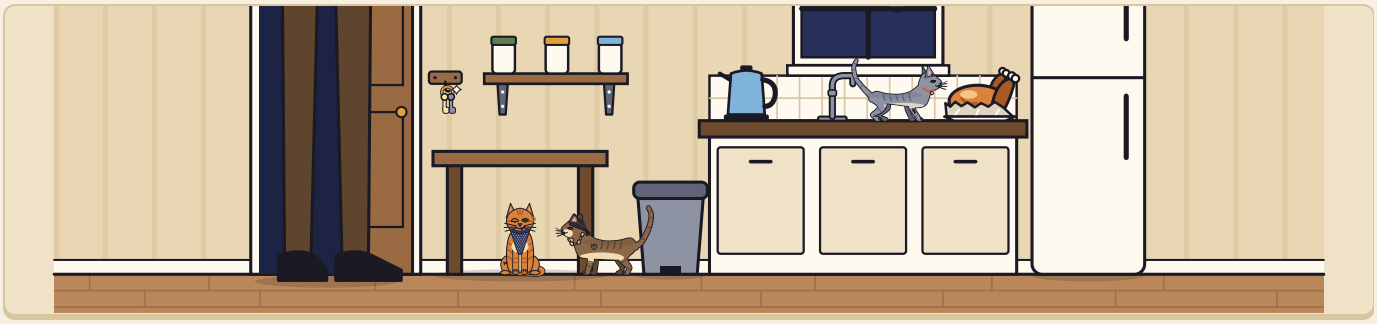
When a cat spends its ninth Life, it has nothing left to spend: the next time it's pinched, it stays in the pound until somebody adopts it. Give it a send-off fit for a legend: tell the tale of its best job one more time, with extra swagger.

PART FOUR

Five Houses

Five jobs, ready to pull tonight: one easy, two standard, two hard.





CHAPTER 15

The Chicken at Number 12

The best first job: one man, one old dog, one chicken. Easy pickings.

READ THIS ALOUD

It's a quarter to seven and the street smells of rain. The gang is lined up along the garden wall, trying to look casual. Mr Pell comes up the path with a shopping bag, and out of the top of it pokes a rotisserie chicken, still warm, wrapped in foil. He fumbles for his key. The door opens. From the kitchen comes the thump-thump of his old dog Pudding's tail. The door begins to close… Right. Time to go to work.

AT A GLANCE

House Easy · **Patience** 4 · **The prize** rotisserie chicken (Medium, portions: 1 per cat + 1) · **Gone** at the start of round 10 · **Den** Downstairs loo

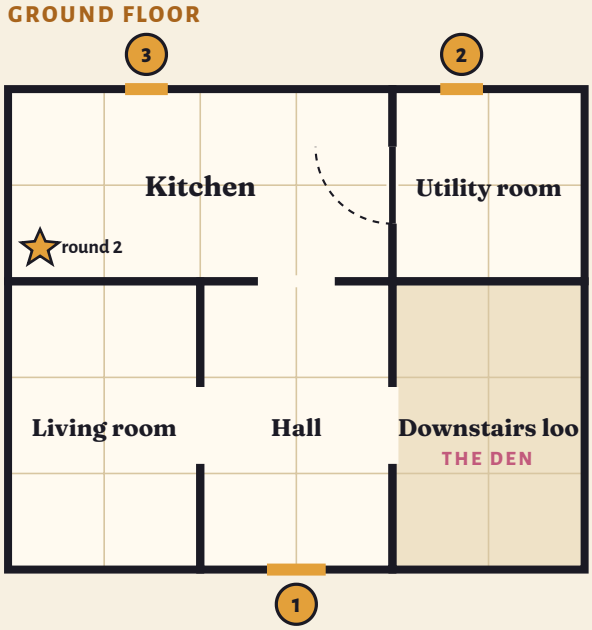
Who lives here Mr Pell, Pudding

Three cats Patience 5, gone at the start of round 12, Lights Out at the end of round 14, 3 Cattitude each · **Five cats** Patience 3

Number 12 is a small terraced house: hall, living room, kitchen at the back with a utility room off it, and a downstairs loo. Mr Pell lives alone with Pudding, a soft old spaniel who would rather be fed than fight. He'll put the chicken on the kitchen counter in its foil and potter about until he eats it.

How it plays

- **The quick way** is the kitchen window: it's a climb, but it puts you next to the chicken.
- **The unseen way** is through the cat flap — nobody's in the utility room, but it clacks, and then there's the utility door to open.
- Mr Pell spends a lot of time in the kitchen. A Charmer who keeps him busy, or a cat who lures him to the living room, is worth a lot. Pudding is awake, and easy to befriend.
- **Showing off:** the catnip cushion is on Mr Pell's armchair, and the Bin Lid Boys have tagged the kitchen, right under Pudding's nose.
- The chicken is gone at the start of round 10. That's quick: no hanging about.



ENTRANCES

1. Front door (behind Mr Pell) — Big; Sweet; or Sneaky, Hard (round 1 only, one cat)
2. Cat flap in the back door — Normal; no roll; makes noise
3. Open kitchen window (up the bins) — Normal; Sneaky or Savage, Tricky; a climb: Small things only

A door drawn shut with a dashed swing is closed (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard to open, unless the house says otherwise). The star marks where the prize is put down, and in which round. One square is about two cat lengths.

The Chicken at Number 12: the floor plan and the entrances.

The Prize Clock

WHEN	THE PRIZE
Start of round 2	Mr Pell puts it in the kitchen and stays there this round. Step 1: climb up to it (a Climber's Knack) (Sneaky or Savage, Tricky); then step 2: get the wrapping off (a Curious cat's Knack) (Streetwise or Savage, Tricky).
Start of round 10	Gone — unless the gang has got it out or a cat is holding it.
End of round 12	Lights Out: any cat still inside is pinched.

The rooms

ROOM	TEMPTS	NOTES
Hall	Curious	—
Living room	Box Sitter, Lap Cat, Knocker	the catnip stash: a catnip cushion on Mr Pell's armchair (tempts every cat)
Kitchen	Foodie, Knocker, Climber	door to the utility room (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard); the Bin Lid Boys' tag
Utility room	Hunter, Curious	door to the kitchen (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard)
Downstairs loo	—	**the Den**

Every room also has shiny things (Curious, Knocker; Chapter 7). **Ways between rooms:** Hall–Living room Big · Hall–Kitchen Big · Kitchen–Utility room Big (door) · Hall–Downstairs loo Big (the Den's door: open; shut while a cat is shut in).

The **cat flap** clacks every time a cat uses it. The **kitchen window** is open wide above the sink: up the bins and in. The utility room door to the kitchen is shut; it has a lever handle.

Who lives here

Mr Pell
Grown-up

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Hall

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3–4 Kitchen; 5–6 Living room.

Pudding
Dog

RATING 2 **STARTS IN** Kitchen, awake

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3 Living room; 4 Kitchen; 5 Hall; 6 sniffs one room toward the nearest cat.

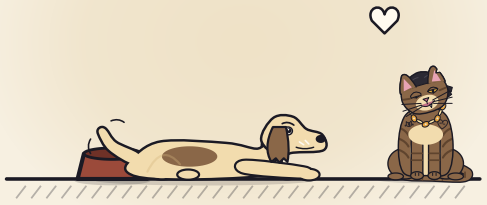
Dog: Barks, charges and smells hidden cats (Chapter 11).
Soft: Sweet can befriend it.

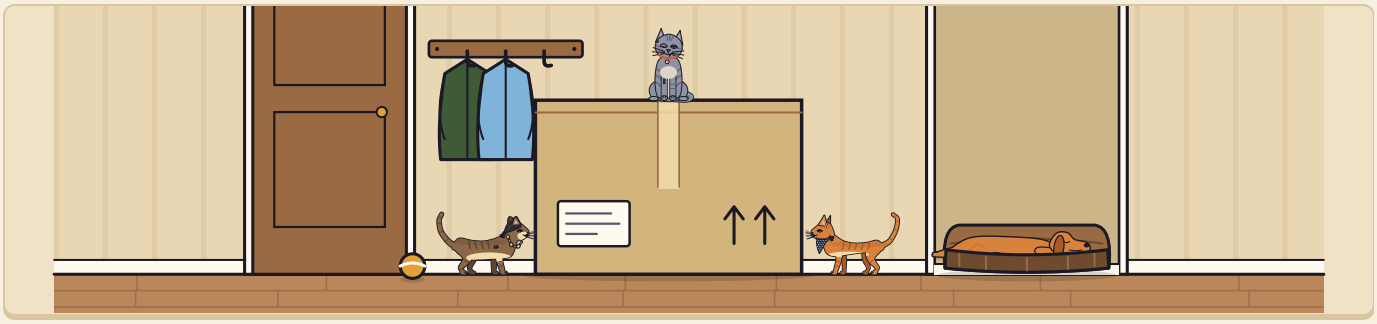
THE GETAWAY

1. **Mr Pell's back fence** — Savage or Sneaky (Knack: a Climber's).
2. **The allotments** — Sneaky or Savage (Knack: a Box Sitter's; a Hunter's, to bolt). *The Bin Lid Boys hang about here, and nick any loot that's dropped.*
3. **The alley wall** — Savage or Sneaky, Tricky (Knack: a Climber's).
4. **Station Road** — Streetwise or Savage (Knack: a Hunter's, to bolt).

Then the hideout. The loot is its portions — whatever wasn't eaten inside.

Cred (Chapter 9): the catnip stash is a catnip cushion on Mr Pell's armchair (living room). The Bin Lid Boys have already tagged the kitchen — the cheek of it.





CHAPTER 16

The Okafors' Big Box

It doesn't matter what's in it. It's a box, and it's ours.

READ THIS ALOUD

A van stops outside Number 31. The courier staggers up the path with the biggest box any of you have ever seen. Every cat on the wall goes very still. Mrs Okafor signs for it in the doorway while her son Tayo bounces behind her. She drags it into the hall. Somewhere in the kitchen a dog barks once, sleepily, and stops. Biggest score of the year, and it's sitting in the hall.

AT A GLANCE

House Standard · **Patience** 8 · **The prize** big delivery box (Large) · **Gone** at the start of round 13 · **Den** Tayo's room

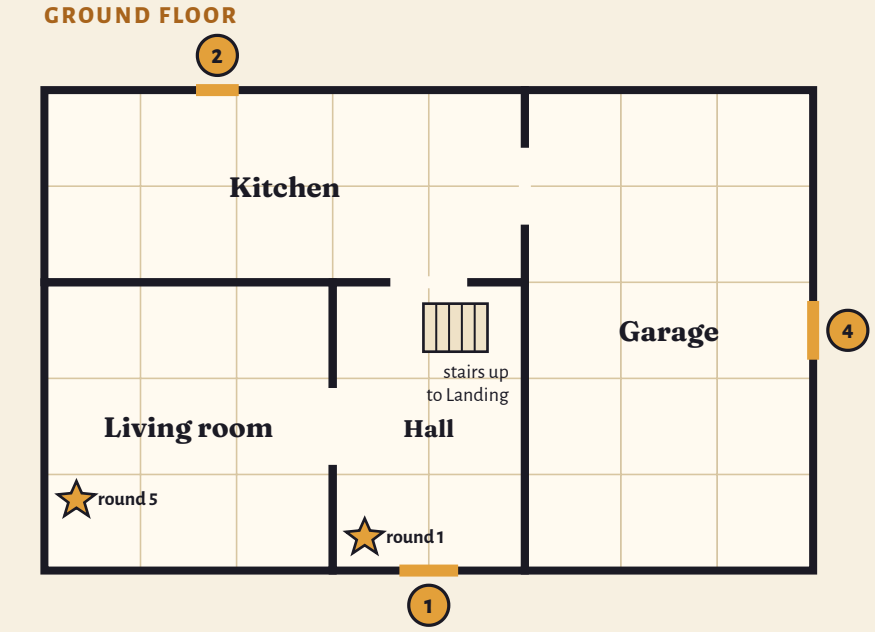
Who lives here Mrs Okafor, Tayo, Noodle

Three cats Patience 9, gone at the start of round 15, Lights Out at the end of round 17, 3 Cattitude each · **Five cats** Patience 7

The Okafors' house has a hall, a living room, a long kitchen with a dog door, and a garage with its side door left ajar. Upstairs are the bathroom, the landing and Tayo's room. Mrs Okafor will unpack the box in the living room, and then she'll flatten it for the recycling. The gang wants it before that — the whole thing, out of the house and all the way back to the hideout.

How it plays

- This is a carrying job. Get three cats onto the box, then haul it room by room: every move of the box is a roll, and a human watching takes a die off a Sneaky haul and adds to the Mood.
- Waiting it out won't work for long: at the start of round 5 Mrs Okafor comes for the box, and if it isn't where she left it, she starts **Searching**.
- Tayo is a kid: Sweet rolls he sees fill Cuddle twice as fast. Distract his mum, not him.
- Noodle sleeps in the kitchen, right on the way out. Don't wake him — or befriend him; he's soft.
- If someone Shoos a cat out through the garage, the side door shuts — and that's the box's only way out. Reopen it from inside (Streetwise, Hard).



ENTRANCES

1. Front door (behind Mrs Okafor) — Big; Sweet; or Sneaky, Hard (round 1 only, one cat)
2. Dog door — Normal; no roll
3. Bathroom window (over the shed roof) — Normal; Sneaky or Savage, Tricky; a climb: Small things only
4. Garage side door, ajar — Big; no roll

A door drawn shut with a dashed swing is closed (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard to open, unless the house says otherwise). The star marks where the prize is put down, and in which round. One square is about two cat lengths.

The Okafors' Big Box: the floor plan and the entrances.

The Prize Clock

WHEN	THE PRIZE
Start of round 1	Mrs Okafor puts it in the hall and stays there this round. No roll to get at it.
Start of round 5	Mrs Okafor puts it in the living room and stays there this round. No roll to get at it.
Start of round 13	Gone — unless the gang has got it out or a cat is holding it.
End of round 15	Lights Out: any cat still inside is pinched.

The rooms

ROOM	TEMPTS	NOTES
Hall	Box Sitter	—
Living room	Lap Cat, Hunter, Knocker	—
Kitchen	Foodie, Curious	—
Garage	Hunter, Climber	the Satin Paws' tag
Landing	Climber	—
Bathroom	—	—
Tayo's room	Box Sitter	**the Den**; the catnip stash: Tayo's catnip fish, under the bed (tempts every cat)

Every room also has shiny things (Curious, Knocker; Chapter 7). **Ways between rooms:** Hall–Living room Big · Hall–Kitchen Big · Kitchen–Garage Big · Hall–Landing

Normal · Landing–Bathroom Big · Landing–Tayo's room Big (the Den's door: open; shut while a cat is shut in).

The box is **Large**: it takes three cats to move (or two with a Chonky one), and it only fits through Big ways. The only Big way out after round 1 is the **garage side door**, through the kitchen.

Who lives here

Mrs Okafor
Grown-up

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Hall

Routine (d6): 1–3 stays put; 4 Kitchen; 5–6 Living room.

Tayo
Kid

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Living room

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3–4 Tayo's room; 5 Living room; 6 Kitchen.

Kid: Doubles Cuddle steps from any roll they see.

Noodle
Dog

RATING 2 **STARTS IN** Kitchen, asleep

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3 Hall; 4 Garage; 5 Living room; 6 sniffs one room toward the nearest cat.

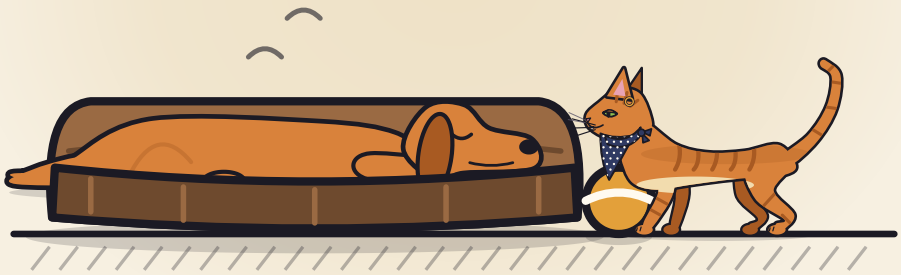
Dog: Barks, charges and smells hidden cats (Chapter 11).
Soft: Sweet can befriend it.

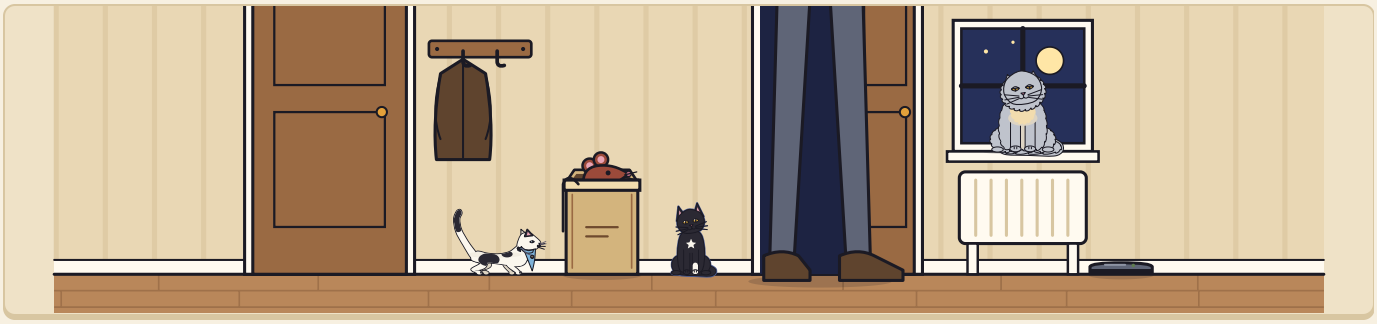
THE GETAWAY

1. **The side gate, left on the latch** — Streetwise or Savage (Knack: a Curious cat's; a Climber's).
2. **Next door's terrier** — Savage or Sneaky or Sweet (Knack: a Scrapper's; a Box Sitter's; a Lap Cat's); rating 1 (it takes 1 die off).
3. **The garage roofs** — Savage or Sneaky, Tricky (Knack: a Climber's). *The Satin Paws hang about here, and nick any loot that's dropped.*
4. **The main road** — Streetwise or Savage (Knack: a Hunter's, to bolt).

Then the hideout. The loot is 3 pieces.

Cred (Chapter 9): the catnip stash is Tayo's catnip fish, under the bed (Tayo's room). The Satin Paws have already tagged the garage — the cheek of it.





CHAPTER 17

Grandpa Wendell's Catnip Mouse

"It's for Pom-Pom. She deserves nice things." "So do we."

READ THIS ALOUD

Grandpa Wendell comes home from the pet shop with a paper bag, and through the paper you can smell it: catnip. A whole catnip mouse, red felt, with a string tail. His daughter June is in the kitchen putting the kettle on. In the front window, a large fluffy grey cat called Pom-Pom watches you all with deep contempt. You give her the same look right back.

AT A GLANCE

House Standard · **Patience** 9 · **The prize** catnip mouse (Small) · **Gone** at the start of round 9 · **Den** Bathroom

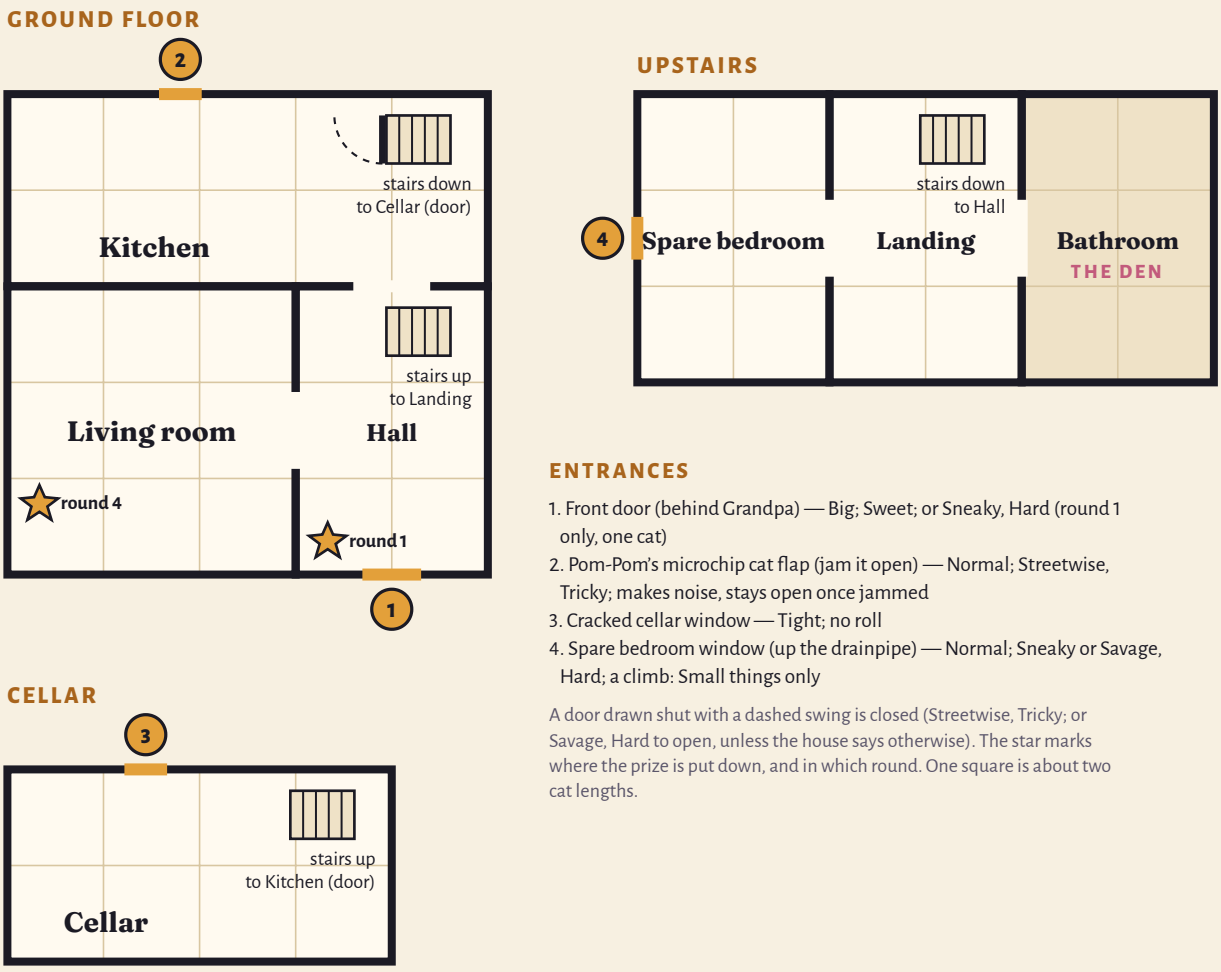
Who lives here Grandpa Wendell, June, Pom-Pom, the robot vacuum

Three cats Patience 10, gone at the start of round 11, Lights Out at the end of round 13, 3 Cattitude each · **Five cats** Patience 8

Grandpa Wendell's house has a hall, a front room where Pom-Pom rules, a kitchen with Pom-Pom's microchip cat flap, a cellar under the kitchen with a cracked window, and upstairs a spare bedroom, a landing and the bathroom. The mouse is small — one cat can carry it — but it has to get out of the house, and Pom-Pom will want it too.

How it plays

- Grab the mouse from the paper bag in the hall before Grandpa gives it to Pom-Pom at the start of round 4. After that you have to get past her.
- Grandpa dozes. A sleeping Grandpa sees nothing — perfect for a quick snatch.
- The robot vacuum tempts Hunters wherever it goes — and can be ridden.
- Getting out is the hard part: plan the exit before you grab the mouse.



ENTRANCES

1. Front door (behind Grandpa) — Big; Sweet; or Sneaky, Hard (round 1 only, one cat)
2. Pom-Pom's microchip cat flap (jam it open) — Normal; Streetwise, Tricky; makes noise, stays open once jammed
3. Cracked cellar window — Tight; no roll
4. Spare bedroom window (up the drainpipe) — Normal; Sneaky or Savage, Hard; a climb: Small things only

A door drawn shut with a dashed swing is closed (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard to open, unless the house says otherwise). The star marks where the prize is put down, and in which round. One square is about two cat lengths.

Grandpa Wendell's Catnip Mouse: the floor plan and the entrances.

The Prize Clock

WHEN	THE PRIZE
Start of round 1	Grandpa Wendell puts it in the hall and stays there this round. Step 1: get it out of the bag (a Curious cat's Knack) (Streetwise or Sneaky, Tricky).
Start of round 4	Grandpa Wendell puts it in the living room and stays there this round. No roll to get at it.
Start of round 9	Gone — unless the gang has got it out or a cat is holding it.
End of round 11	Lights Out: any cat still inside is pinched.

The rooms

ROOM	TEMPTS	NOTES
Hall	Curious	—
Living room	Hunter, Lap Cat, Box Sitter	—
Kitchen	Foodie, Knocker	door to the cellar (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard)
Cellar	Hunter, Curious	door to the kitchen (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard); the Canal Street Toms' tag
Landing	—	—
Spare bedroom	Climber, Box Sitter	the catnip stash: Grandpa's pots of catnip on the windowsill (tempts every cat)
Bathroom	Box Sitter	**the Den**

Every room also has shiny things (Curious, Knocker; Chapter 7). **Ways between rooms:** Hall–Living room Big · Hall–Kitchen Big · Kitchen–Cellar Normal (door) · Hall–

Landing Normal · Landing–Spare bedroom Big · Landing–Bathroom Big (the Den's door: open; shut while a cat is shut in).

Pom-Pom's **cat flap** only opens for her microchip; jam it (Streetwise, Tricky) and it stays open for everyone — but it rattles every time a cat goes through (a noisy entrance). The **front door** lets one cat in behind Grandpa in round 1. The **cellar window** is Tight: Lean cats only. The **bedroom window** is up the drainpipe: Hard.

Who lives here

Grandpa Wendell
Grandparent

ATTENTION 0 **STARTS IN** Hall

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3–4 Hall; 5 Living room; 6 Kitchen.

Dozes: Every house's turn on a 1–2 (extra d6), asleep until the end of the next round; only a Prize Clock job wakes them.

June
Grown-up

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Kitchen

Routine (d6): 1–3 stays put; 4 Living room; 5 Hall; 6 Landing.

Pom-Pom
House cat

RATING 2 **GUARDS** Living room

House cat: Guards its room (Chapter 11). **Soft:** Sweet can befriend her.

The robot vacuum
Robot vacuum

STARTS IN Living room **GOES** Living room, Hall, Kitchen

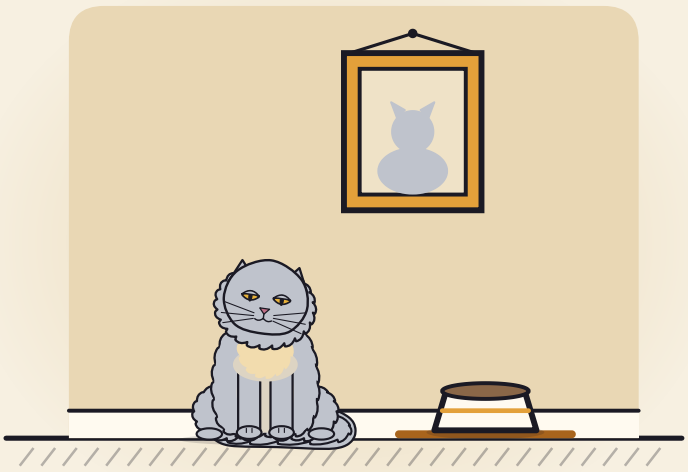
Vacuum: Wanders one room a round; tempts Hunters; can be ridden (Chapter 11).

THE GETAWAY

1. **The garden wall** — Savage or Sneaky (Knack: a Climber's).
2. **The greenhouse** — Sneaky or Streetwise, Tricky (Knack: a Box Sitter's; a Curious cat's).
3. **The canal fence** — Savage or Sneaky, Tricky (Knack: a Climber's). *The Canal Street Toms hang about here, and nick any loot that's dropped.*
4. **The footbridge** — Savage or Sneaky (Knack: a Hunter's, to bolt).

Then the hideout. The loot is 1 piece.

Cred (Chapter 9): the catnip stash is Grandpa's pots of catnip on the windowsill (spare bedroom). The Canal Street Toms have already tagged the cellar — the cheek of it.





CHAPTER 18

The Birthday Cake

Happy birthday, Mia. Sorry about the cake.

READ THIS ALOUD

There are balloons on the gate of Number 5 and music inside. Dad carries a cake in from the car and straight through to the kitchen — chocolate, three layers, under a plastic cover — and the guests are still arriving. In the dining room, a grey parrot shouts "PARTY!" at nobody. Aunt Rosalind, who notices everything, is already sitting in the best chair. Bad odds. Very good cake.

AT A GLANCE

House Hard · **Patience** 6 · **The prize** birthday cake (Medium, portions: 2 per cat; hauling it is Tricky) · **Gone** at the start of round 9 · **Den** Downstairs loo

Who lives here Dad, Aunt Rosalind, Mia, Leo, Captain the parrot

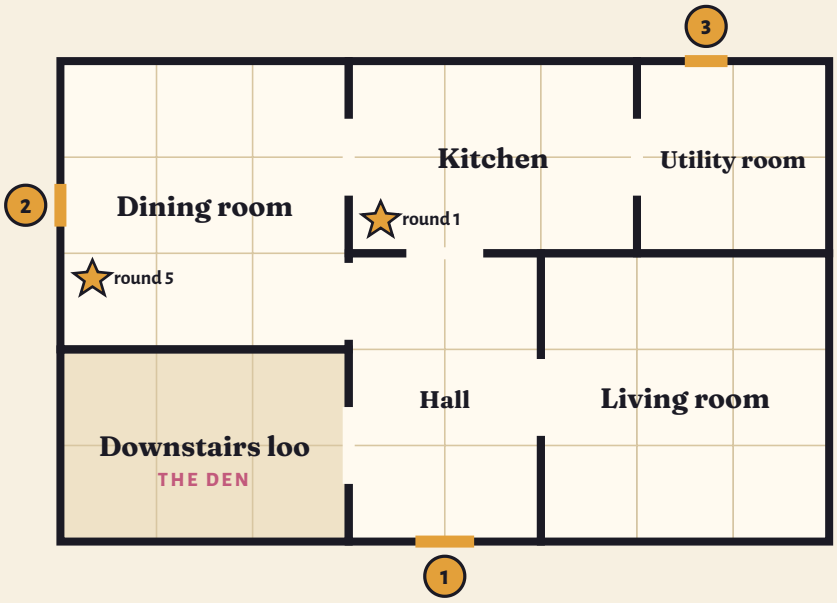
Three cats Patience 7, gone at the start of round 10, Lights Out at the end of round 12, 3 Cattitude each · **Five cats** Patience 5, gone at the start of round 10, Lights Out at the end of round 12

A BIRTHDAY PARTY: THE HOUSE IS FULL OF PEOPLE. DAD IS in the kitchen with the cake, Aunt Rosalind holds court in the dining room, and Mia and her brother Leo run everywhere. The patio door is open for the guests. At the start of round 5 the cake goes to the dining-room table for the candles, and it will be cut and served at the start of round 9.

How it plays

- There are four humans and a parrot. You can't distract them all; work out who will be where.
- Aunt Rosalind has Attention 2: Sneaky and Sweet are hard under her nose.
- Two kids double every Cuddle step — and once Cuddle is the fuller meter, any cat's Flop in front of a kid is 4 Cuddle steps. The Muscle gets scooped here too.
- The cake **wobbles**: hauling it is Tricky. And the gang can only carry a slice each over the fences (two for a Chonky cat), so eat most of it inside — the surer plan anyway.
- Eating half the cake is a Messy Getaway — and at this house that's a good night.

GROUND FLOOR



ENTRANCES

1. Front door (guests arriving) — Big; Sweet; or Sneaky, Hard (rounds 1–2 only, one cat)
2. Patio door, ajar — Big; no roll
3. Utility window (up the water butt) — Normal; Sneaky or Savage, Tricky; a climb: Small things only

A door drawn shut with a dashed swing is closed (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard to open, unless the house says otherwise). The star marks where the prize is put down, and in which round. One square is about two cat lengths.

The Birthday Cake: the floor plan and the entrances.

The Prize Clock

WHEN	THE PRIZE
Start of round 1	Dad puts it in the kitchen and stays there this round. Step 1: climb up to it (a Climber's Knack) (Sneaky or Savage, Tricky); then step 2: get the wrapping off (a Curious cat's Knack) (Streetwise or Savage, Tricky).
Start of round 5	Dad puts it in the dining room and stays there this round. Step 1: climb up to it (a Climber's Knack) (Sneaky or Savage, Tricky).
Start of round 9	Gone — unless the gang has got it out or a cat is holding it.
End of round 11	Lights Out: any cat still inside is pinched.

The rooms

ROOM	TEMPTS	NOTES
Hall	Curious, Box Sitter	the Party Crashers' tag
Kitchen	Foodie, Knocker	—
Dining room	Hunter, Climber	—
Living room	Hunter, Box Sitter, Lap Cat	—
Utility room	Curious	the catnip stash: a catnip toy, wrapped as a present for Gran's cat (tempts every cat)
Downstairs loo	—	**the Den**

Every room also has shiny things (Curious, Knocker; Chapter 7). **Ways between rooms:** Hall–Kitchen Big · Hall–Living room Big · Hall–Dining room Big · Kitchen–Dining room Big · Kitchen–Utility room Big · Hall–Downstairs loo Big (the Den's door: open; shut while a cat is shut in).

The **front door** keeps opening for guests, so it works in rounds 1 and 2 (one cat each round); the guests count as a human with Attention 0 who fills no meter, though a Scrape or Flop at the door is still a noise in the hall. The **patio door** is open and needs no roll — but it opens into the dining room, where Aunt Rosalind and Captain are.

Who lives here

Dad
Grown-up

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Kitchen

Routine (d6): 1 stays put; 2–3 Kitchen; 4–5 Dining room; 6 Living room.

Aunt Rosalind
Grown-up

ATTENTION 2 **STARTS IN** Dining room

Routine (d6): 1–4 stays put; 5 Kitchen; 6 Living room.

Mia
Kid

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Living room

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3 Dining room; 4 Hall; 5 Kitchen; 6 Living room.

Kid: Doubles Cuddle steps from any roll they see.

Leo
Kid

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Living room

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3–4 Dining room; 5 Hall; 6 Living room.

Kid: Doubles Cuddle steps from any roll they see.

Captain the parrot
Parrot

LIVES IN Dining room

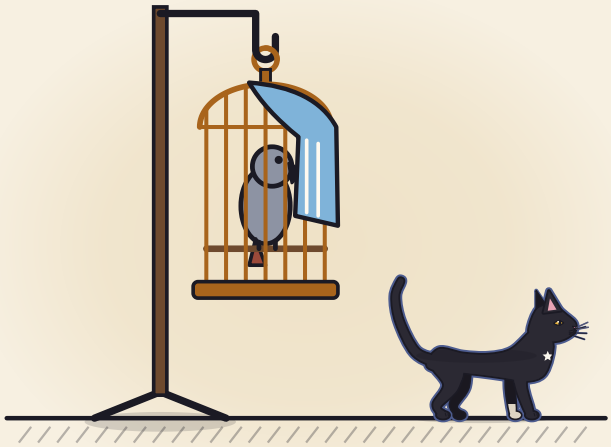
Parrot: Squawks at cats it can see; cover the cage (Streetwise, Tricky) to quiet it (Chapter 11).

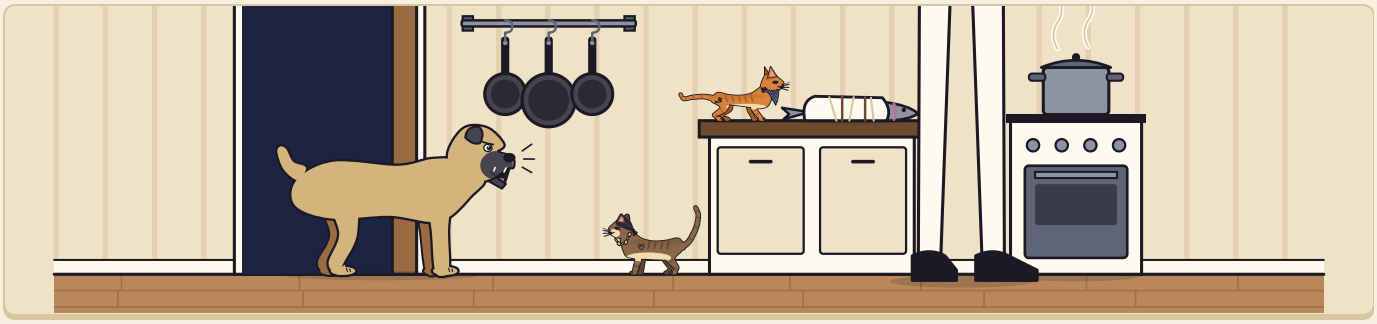
THE GETAWAY

1. **The party gate, through the guests' legs** — Sweet; or Sneaky or Savage, Tricky (Knack: a Box Sitter's; a Lap Cat's; a Hunter's, to bolt).
2. **Next door's bouncy castle** — Savage or Sneaky, Tricky (Knack: a Climber's). *The Party Crashers hang about here, and nick any loot that's dropped.*
3. **The high back fence** — Savage, Tricky; or Sneaky, Hard (Knack: a Climber's).
4. **The ring road** — Streetwise or Savage, Tricky (Knack: a Hunter's, to bolt).

Then the hideout. The loot is its portions — whatever wasn't eaten inside.

Cred (Chapter 9): the catnip stash is a catnip toy, wrapped as a present for Gran's cat (utility room). The Party Crashers have already tagged the hall — the cheek of it.





CHAPTER 19

Chef Marchetti's Salmon

The best fish on the street, in the hardest kitchen on the street.

READ THIS ALOUD

Chef Marchetti carries a whole salmon past Sam at the front door and straight through to her kitchen like a trophy, wrapped in paper from the fish market. From the utility room comes a deep, slow woof, and then the claws of a very big dog on a tiled floor. The kitchen lights go on, and they stay on. This is the big score, and everybody on the wall knows it.

AT A GLANCE

House Hard · **Patience** 7 · **The prize** whole salmon (Medium, portions: 1 per cat + 2) · **Gone** at the start of round 9 · **Den** Study

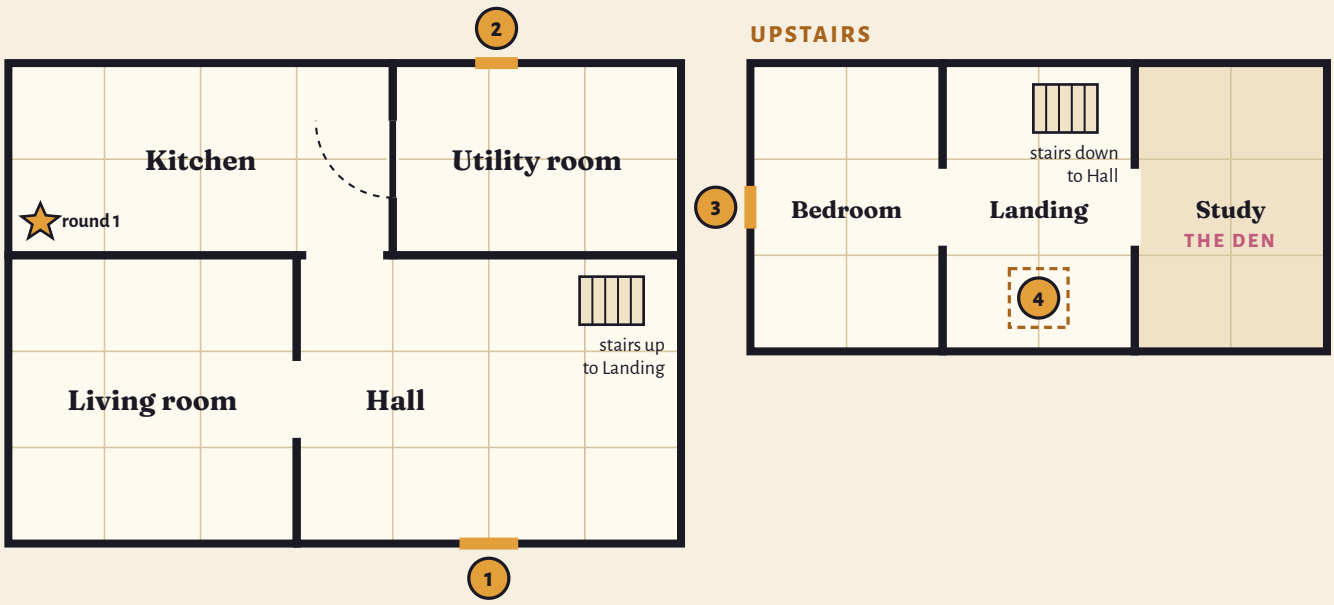
Who lives here Chef Marchetti, Sam, Brutus, the robot vacuum

Three cats Patience 8, gone at the start of round 12, Lights Out at the end of round 14, 3 Cattitude each · **Five cats** Patience 6

Chef Marchetti cooks for a living, and she hardly ever leaves her kitchen while there's a fish on the island. Her partner Sam wanders the house. Their dog Brutus is enormous and not the least bit soft. Upstairs there's a balcony door up the tree, a skylight propped open, a bedroom and a study.

How it plays

- Chef Marchetti is **busy**: no noise will lure her out of the kitchen. She has Attention 2. You will have to work under her nose — or distract her, which gets harder every time.
- Brutus can't be befriended. Drive him off (rating 3: bring your Muscle) or stay out of his way.
- Brutus's dog door is a heavy flap: every cat through it makes a noise, right in his room. The way in from upstairs is long but quiet.
- The fish is a lot of portions, and every one is a roll under the Chef's nose. Carrying it out past Brutus is fewer rolls, but a carrier can't hide and every haul can fail; most gangs do better eating it. This house keeps more cats than any other: keep the dog door open for the Chonky ones (the skylight is Tight).



ENTRANCES

1. Front door (behind Sam) — Big; Sweet; or Sneaky, Hard (round 1 only, one cat)
2. Brutus's dog door (a heavy flap) — Normal; no roll; makes noise
3. Balcony door (up the tree) — Normal; Sneaky or Savage, Hard; a climb: Small things only
4. Skylight, propped open — Tight; Sneaky or Savage, Tricky; a climb: Small things only

A door drawn shut with a dashed swing is closed (Streetwise, Tricky; or Savage, Hard to open, unless the house says otherwise). The star marks where the prize is put down, and in which round. One square is about two cat lengths.

Chef Marchetti's Salmon: the floor plan and the entrances.

The Prize Clock

WHEN	THE PRIZE
Start of round 1	Chef Marchetti puts it in the kitchen and stays there this round. Step 1: climb up to it (a Climber's Knack) (Sneaky or Savage, Tricky); then step 2: get the wrapping off (a Curious cat's Knack) (Streetwise or Savage, Tricky).
Start of round 9	Gone — unless the gang has got it out or a cat is holding it.
End of round 11	Lights Out: any cat still inside is pinched.

The rooms

ROOM	TEMPTS	NOTES
Hall	—	—
Kitchen	Foodie, Knocker, Hunter	door to the utility room (Streetwise or Savage, Hard)
Living room	Lap Cat, Box Sitter	—
Utility room	Foodie	door to the kitchen (Streetwise or Savage, Hard); the Fishbone Crew's tag
Landing	—	—
Bedroom	Box Sitter	—
Study	Climber, Curious	**the Den**; the catnip stash: Sam's catnip plant on the desk (tempts every cat)

Every room also has shiny things (Curious, Knocker; Chapter 7). **Ways between rooms:** Hall–Kitchen Big · Hall–Living room Big · Kitchen–Utility room Big (door) · Hall–Landing Normal · Landing–Bedroom Big · Landing–Study Big (the Den's door: open; shut while a cat is shut in).

The **front door** (round 1 only): Sam is holding it, so rolls there are in view of Sam. Brutus's **dog door** is noisy and leads into the utility room, which is Brutus's room. The **skylight** is Tight and a climb. The **balcony door** is Hard, up the tree.

Who lives here

Chef Marchetti
Grown-up

ATTENTION 2 **STARTS IN** Kitchen

Routine (d6): 1–5 Kitchen; 6 Hall.

Busy (cooking): Never answers noise.

Sam
Grown-up

ATTENTION 1 **STARTS IN** Hall

Routine (d6): 1–2 stays put; 3–4 Living room; 5 Kitchen; 6 Study.

Brutus
Dog

RATING 3 **STARTS IN** Utility room, awake

Routine (d6): 1 stays put; 2 Kitchen; 3 Hall; 4 Living room; 5–6 sniffs one room toward the nearest cat.

Dog: Barks, charges and smells hidden cats (Chapter 11). Not soft: Sweet won't work on it.

The robot vacuum
Robot vacuum

STARTS IN Living room **GOES** Living room, Hall, Kitchen

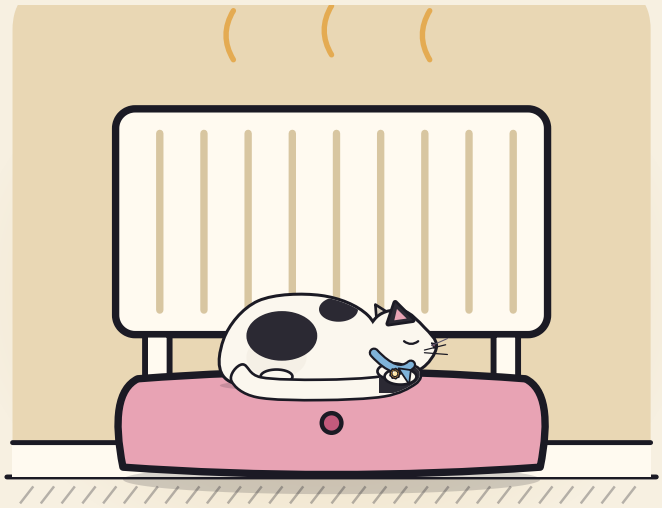
Vacuum: Wanders one room a round; tempts Hunters; can be ridden (Chapter 11).

THE GETAWAY

1. **The restaurant yard** — Sneaky or Savage (Knack: a Box Sitter's; a Hunter's, to bolt).
2. **The fishmonger's cat** — Savage or Sneaky or Sweet (Knack: a Scrapper's; a Box Sitter's; a Lap Cat's); rating 2 (it takes 2 dice off).
3. **The market wall** — Savage or Sneaky, Tricky (Knack: a Climber's). *The Fishbone Crew hang about here, and nick any loot that's dropped.*
4. **The market street** — Streetwise or Savage, Tricky (Knack: a Hunter's, to bolt).

Then the hideout. The loot is its portions — whatever wasn't eaten inside.

Cred (Chapter 9): the catnip stash is Sam's catnip plant on the desk (study). The Fishbone Crew have already tagged the utility room — the cheek of it.



Cat Sheet

Ratings 3, 2, 1, 1 · two instincts · Cattitude 2 each robbery (3 in a gang of three, plus the gang's Rep bonus; max 5) · 9 Lives

DRAW YOUR CAT

Street name _____

Player _____

Coat _____

Mark _____ **Eyes** _____

Quirk _____

Body Lean ☐ Chonky ☐

Lean: fits Tight gaps; carries Small things. **Chonky:** no Tight gaps; carries Medium alone, Large with one other cat; +1 die to wriggle free.

SNEAKY	SWEET	SAVAGE	STREETWISE

INSTINCT	KNACK: +1 DIE TO…	CAN'T RESIST…	GIVING IN

Cattitude ○○○○○ **Lives** ○○○○○○○○○

Right now Inside ☐ Outside ☐ Hidden ☐ Carrying ☐ Held ☐ Shut in ☐ Zoomies ☐ Pinched ☐ **Loot** _____

Gang _____ **Rep** _____ **Rep bonus** _____ **Cred tonight** _____

Notes _____

Roll: approach + Knack (+1) + helpers (+1 each, max 2), max 5 dice; then –1 Tricky, –2 Hard, –a pet's rating, –the watcher's Attention (Sneaky and Sweet only). **0 or fewer:** roll 2, keep the lower, no better than a Scrape. Highest die: 1–3 Flop · 4–5 Scrape · 6 Clean · two 6s Purrfect (+1 Cattitude). **Push** (once a roll): reroll the non-6s for 1 Cattitude or 1 step on that roll's meter. **Tempted?** Give in (+1 Cattitude; it's your Action, first, before you move) or resist (–1 Cattitude).

House Tracker

For the Storyteller · one per robbery

House _____ **Cats** _____ **Patience** _____ **Gone, round** _____ **Lights Out** _____

BROOM	CUDDLE
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Patience after each Shoo! or Scoop _____

ROUND	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
Prize Clock																	
Tempted																	

HUMAN / PET	ROOM NOW	ASLEEP?	SEARCHING?	DISTRACTED	HOLDING	STAYS PUT / HIDING

ENTRANCE	OPEN / SHUT	ENTRANCE	OPEN / SHUT

GETAWAY	GARDEN	PAST 1	PAST 2	PAST 3	HIDEOUT
Cats, loot, warden					

Prize: steps done _____ **Portions left** _____ **Clock spot** _____

Noises this round, in order _____ **Messes in** _____

Tagged _____ **Rivals' tag in** _____ **Catnip got by** _____

Each round: 1 Prize Clock · 2 tempt one cat (not last round's; if it gives in, it goes first) · 3 cats act · 4 pets: wake, bark, squawk, routine · 5 noise: the closest human within 2 rooms (not one already there, holding a cat or staying put) · 6 routines; Searching humans hunt · 7 holders roll · 8 finding it: a Searching human sees a cat +1 Broom; anyone not yet Searching in the prize's room or its Clock room +1 Broom and Searching; a mess found +1 Broom · 9 Lights Out, or no free cat inside, and the prize out, eaten or gone (or the gang ran for it)? Then anyone inside is pinched; the getaway (Ch 9).

Quick Reference

The rules you'll look up at the table · chapter numbers for the rest

COUNTING DICE (CH 4)

Approach + Knack (+1) + helpers (+1 each, max 2), never more than 5. Then take away: Tricky –1, Hard –2, a pet's rating, and on Sneaky or Sweet the watcher's Attention (the highest). **0 or fewer:** roll 2, keep the lower, no better than a Scrape.

HIGHEST DIE	RESULT
1–3	**Flop**: it doesn't work; noise; seen = 2 steps on the fuller meter
4–5	**Scrape**: it works; noise; seen = 1 step
6	**Clean**: it works; seen = 1 step (Sneaky: none)
Two 6s	**Purrfect**: it works; no step; +1 Cattitude

PUSH (CH 4)

Once a roll: reroll every die that isn't a 6. Pay 1 Cattitude, or 1 step on that roll's meter (it always lands, even on a Purrfect).

APPROACH	FILLS	USE IT TO…
Sneaky	Broom	hide, slip past, do it unnoticed
Sweet	Cuddle	distract, befriend, be let in or out
Savage	Broom	shove, bolt, drive off a pet, wriggle free
Streetwise	Broom	doors, latches, bags, flaps, the parrot

SHOO! (BROOM FULL, CH 5)

Out through the nearest entrance the cat fits that works this round (opened if shut), then shut — unless it's the last one open. If it carried the prize: the prize goes back to its Clock spot, steps undone. Meter to 0, Patience –1 (min 2); the other meter drops to one below Patience if it's there.

SCOOPED! (CUDDLE FULL, CH 5, 10)

Held, as above. The holder still sees the room. Holder's d6 in the house's turn: 1–3 cuddles · 4–5 the Den · 6 outside. Wriggle free: Savage, Tricky (Chonky +1; friends help). Den door: a friend next door Streetwise, Tricky; alone, Hard.

TEMPTATION (CH 7)

One cat a round, never the same cat twice running. **Give in:** +1 Cattitude; the instinct thing is your Action, first, before you move; never fills a meter. **Resist:** –1 Cattitude (none? give in).

NOISE, LURES AND DISTRACT (CH 6)

Each noise draws the closest awake human within 2 rooms who isn't there already. A noise made on purpose leaves a mess (+1 Broom when found). **Distract** (Sweet): that human sees nobody until the house's turn; each earlier distraction of them costs a die.

PETS (CH 11)

In an awake dog's room, deal with it first. Savage drives it off for 3 rounds · Sweet befriends a soft one · Sneaky slips past this turn · Flop: chased back. A parrot: cover the cage (Streetwise, Tricky).

IN AND OUT (CH 8)

Front door: its rounds only, one cat a round (Sneaky, Hard, or Sweet). Reopen a shut entrance from inside: Streetwise, Hard. Meow at a door where a human is: Sweet (not with your mouth full).

CATTITUDE	
Gain 1	give in; roll a Purrfect
Spend 1	Push; resist a temptation
Start	2 (3 in a gang of three) + Rep bonus; max 5

SIZE	CARRIED BY
Small	any one cat
Medium	a Chonky cat, or two cats; no climbing
Large	three cats, or two with a Chonky; Big ways

THE PRIZE (CH 8)

Hauling a Medium or Large prize, and **eating** a portion, are always rolls (Sneaky or Savage; plain unless the house says). Carriers can't hide. **Finding it**, end of the house's turn: a Searching human sees a cat +1 Broom · anyone not yet Searching beside the disturbed prize +1 Broom and Searching · a mess found +1 Broom.

THE GETAWAY (CH 9)

Anyone still inside is pinched; the rest run four obstacles home with the loot (food: its portions; else Small 1, Medium 2, Large 3 pieces; one each, Chonky two; a carrier = –1 die to its group, drop a piece to lose it). A Flop: stuck, carriers drop a piece. The warden arrives after round 2 (round 3 if nobody was Shooed or Scooped), then moves 1 a round, 2 after a Flop, never past a cat. On his space: dodge (plain; it works: you stay put and he skips a move) or be pinched, loot and all. No meters; no Sweet with loot.

CRED (CH 9)

Tag a room 1 (one a room; unseen no roll, a mess; in view a roll, +1 if it works) · over the rivals' tag +1 · the catnip 1 · lead past the rivals on a Clean or Purrfect 1 · a getaway Purrfect 1. **The zoomies** until the getaway: +1 die, every roll a noise, every tag a roll, can't resist, Cred ×2. Most Cred: the Cat's Whiskers. Gang's Cred 8+, not Busted: 1 Rep.

HOW IT WENT (CH 9)

Count the whole prize: pieces home + portions eaten inside. **Clean Getaway:** all of it, nobody pinched · **Messy:** at least half (round up), or all but someone pinched · **Busted:** less. Lights Out, 2 rounds after the prize goes: anyone inside is pinched. **Don't run while a friend is held.**

You saw it go in. A chicken. A box. A ring.

You're a gang of alley-cat toughs — big talk, bad ideas, bandanas and very sticky paws — and there's something in that house you want. So you're going in. Barge through the cat flap, sweet-talk the grandad, stare down the dog, grab the loot. Humans don't mind cats. They mind cats who do things. Push it too far and out comes the broom. Be too sweet and somebody scoops you up and won't let go. Then it's over the fences with the loot, dropping bits as you go, while the Five-O — the animal control warden — puffs along behind you with a net.

For 3 to 5 players and a Storyteller, ages 8 and up, one to two hours a job. Five houses ready to hit, a ready-made gang, and rules to build your own street.



Nine lives. One getaway. Make it count.

NINE LIVES GANG · VERSION 0.9